
Test the decision, not just the move

THREE SECTIONS

Exercises 1-48 test repertoire recall, 49-60 test plans and structures, and 61-72 test concrete opening decisions. Recall and concrete decisions are Black to move. Structure tasks always ask for Black's plan, but the diagram caption gives the actual side to move.

HOW TO ANSWER

Write the move or plan, its purpose, and White's strongest relevant resource. Calculate forcing lines before choosing a move. Cover the answer section until you finish a group.

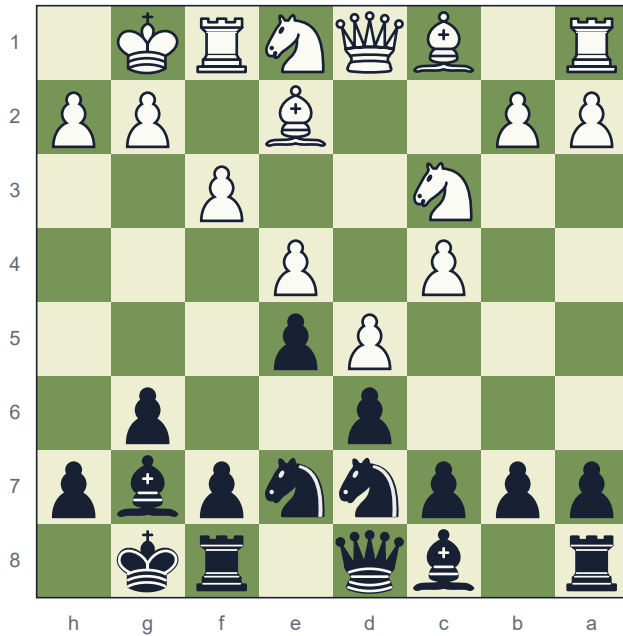
SCORING

Award one point for a sound move or plan, one for the explanation, and one for White's counterplay: maximum 216. The recall key gives the course move, not a claim that every alternative is wrong. Use the score to locate weak topics, not as an Elo estimate.

HOW TO REPAIR A MISS

Find the referenced booklet and line ID. Reconstruct the position, explain the missed idea, and replay the line tomorrow without looking. Repeat after three days and again after one week.

Exercises 01-02



Black to move

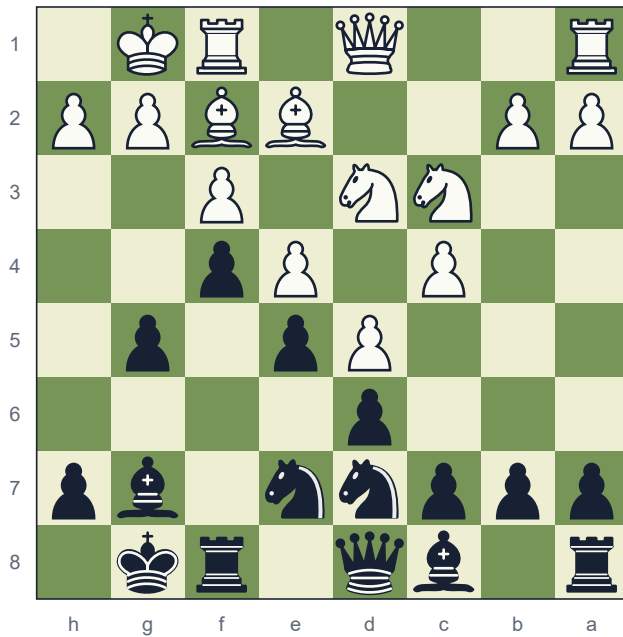
01. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

02. Black repertoire recall

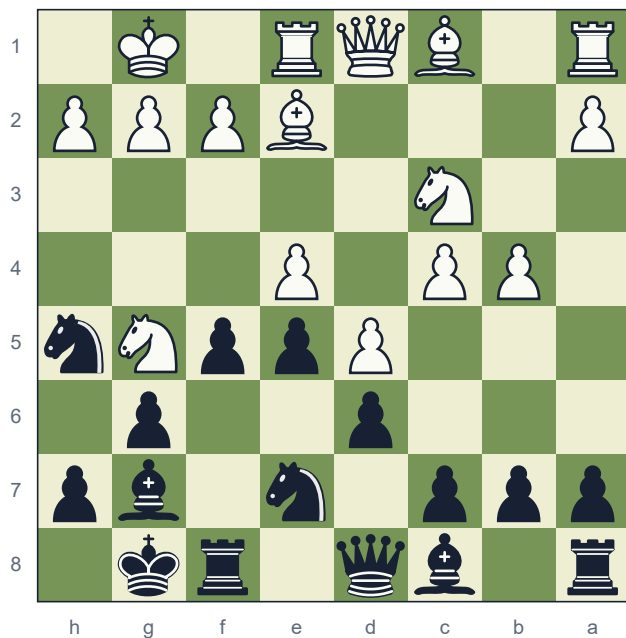
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 03-04



Black to move

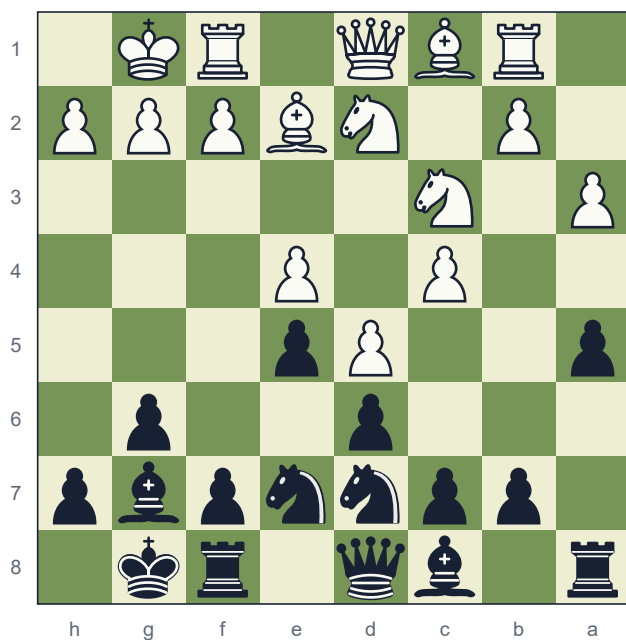
03. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

04. Black repertoire recall

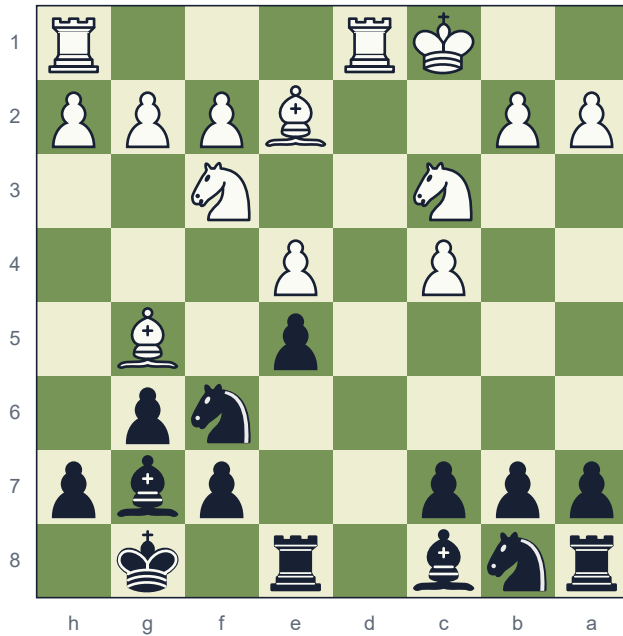
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 05-06



Black to move

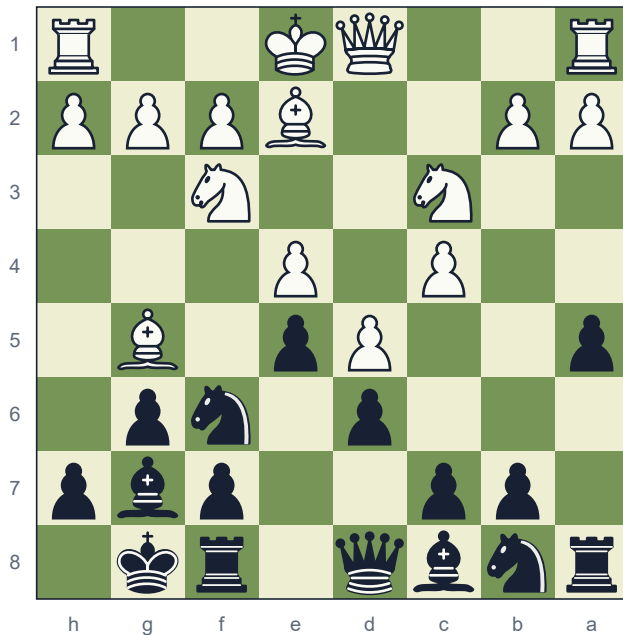
05. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

06. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

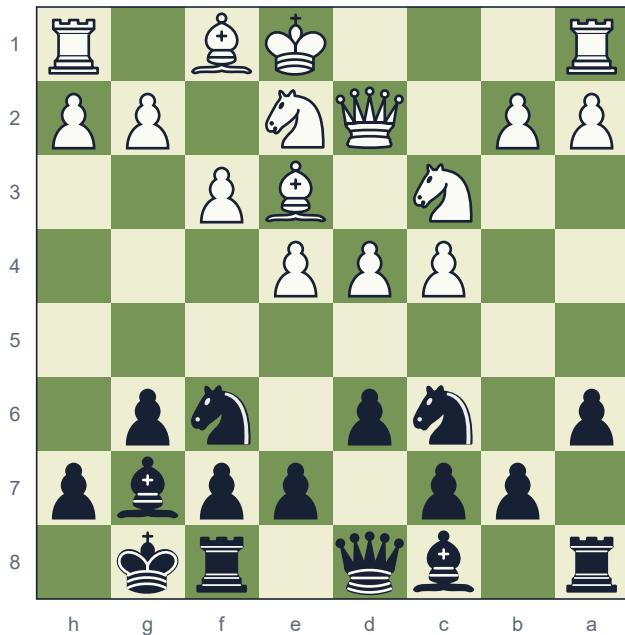
h g f e d c b a

07. Black repertoire recall

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



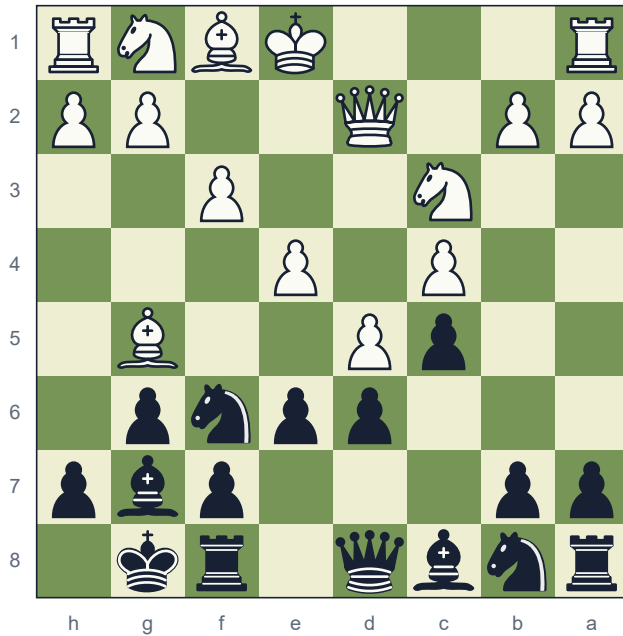
08. Black repertoire recall

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 09-10



Black to move

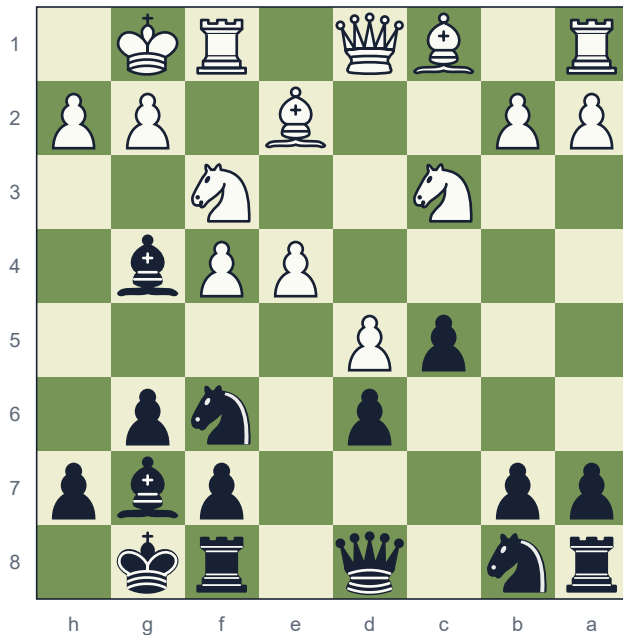
09. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

10. Black repertoire recall

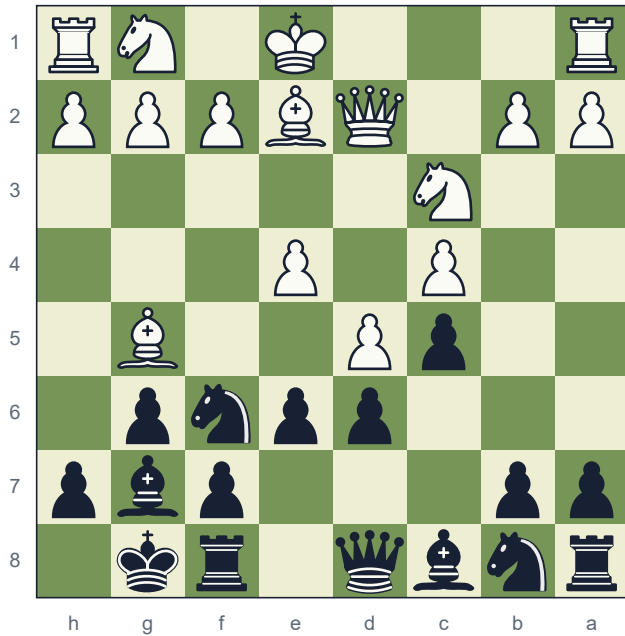
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 11-12



Black to move

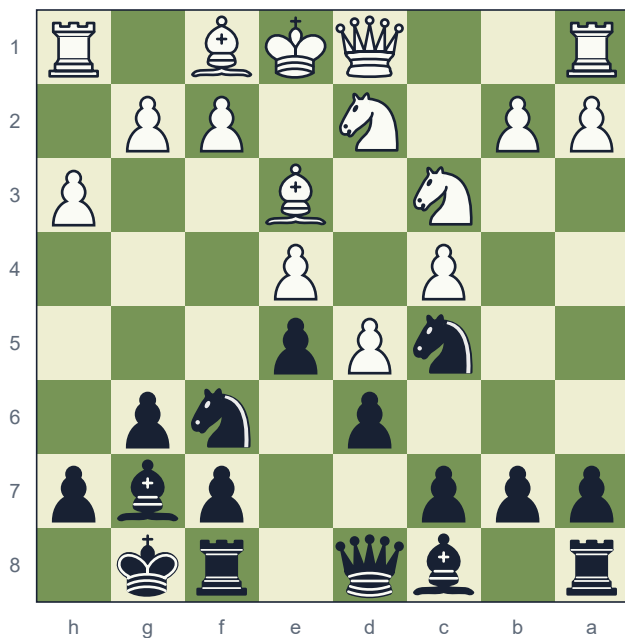
11. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

12. Black repertoire recall

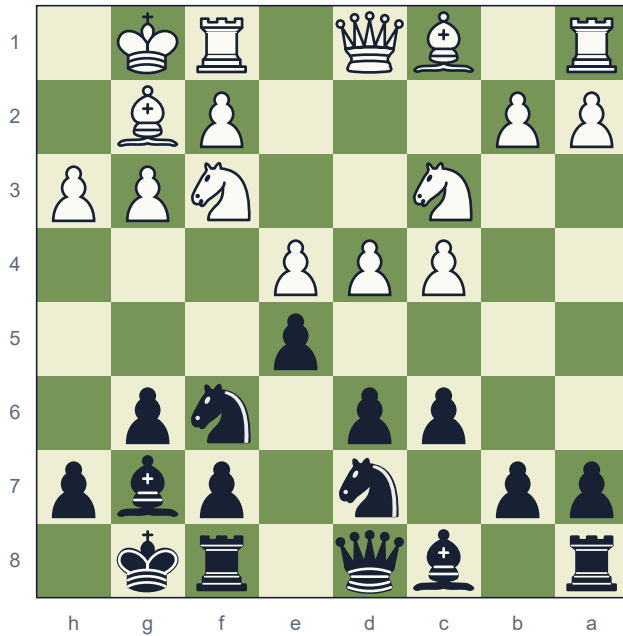
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 13-14



Black to move

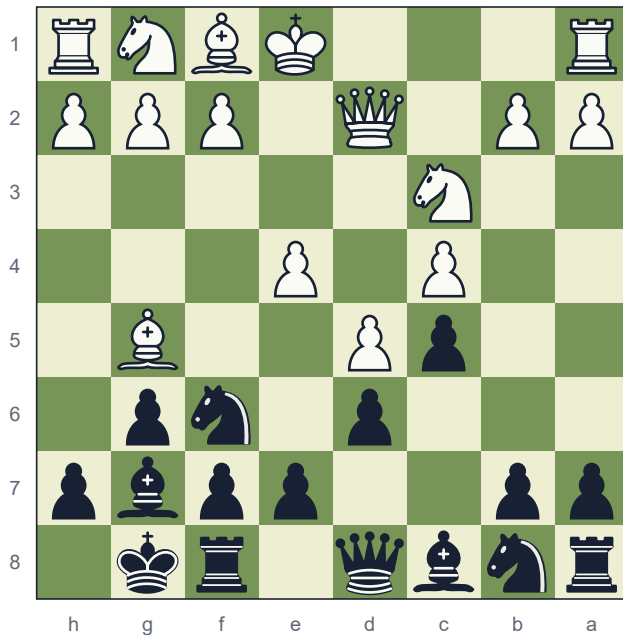
13. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

14. Black repertoire recall

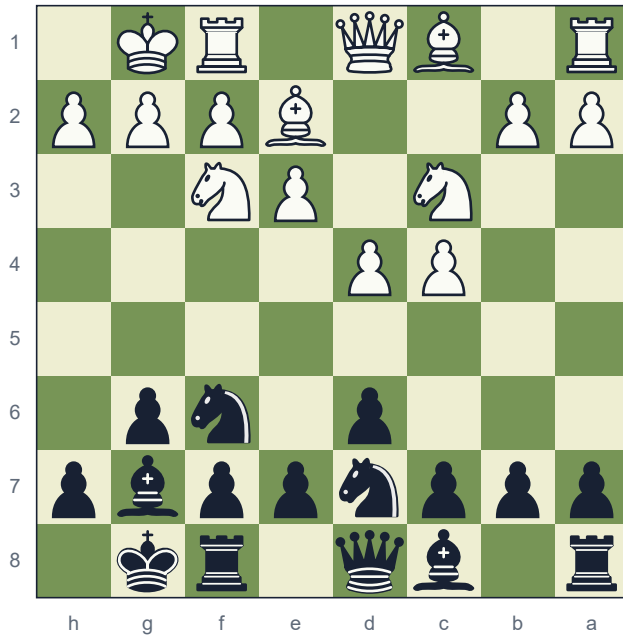
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 15-16



Black to move

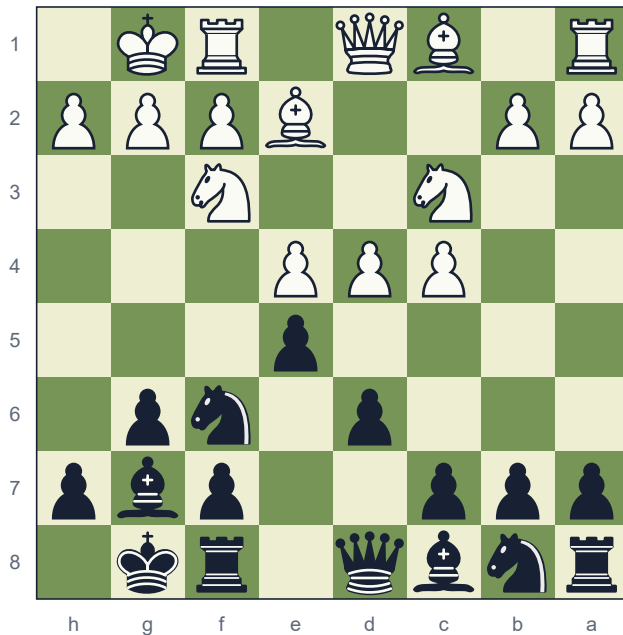
15. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

16. Black repertoire recall

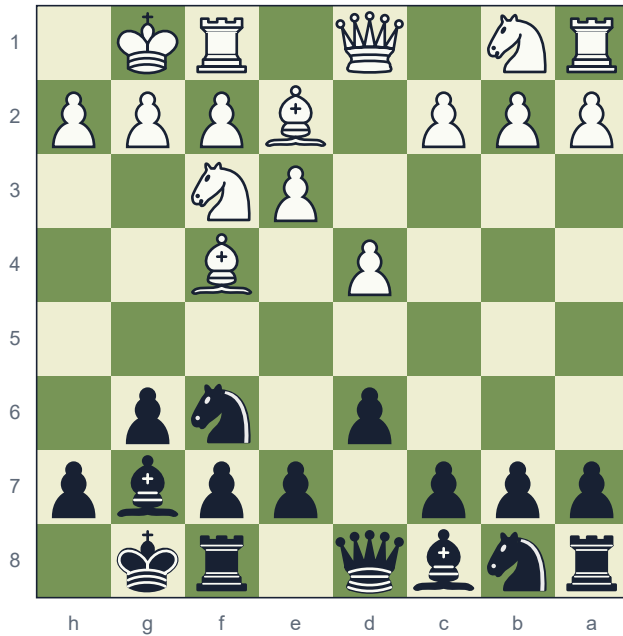
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 17-18



Black to move

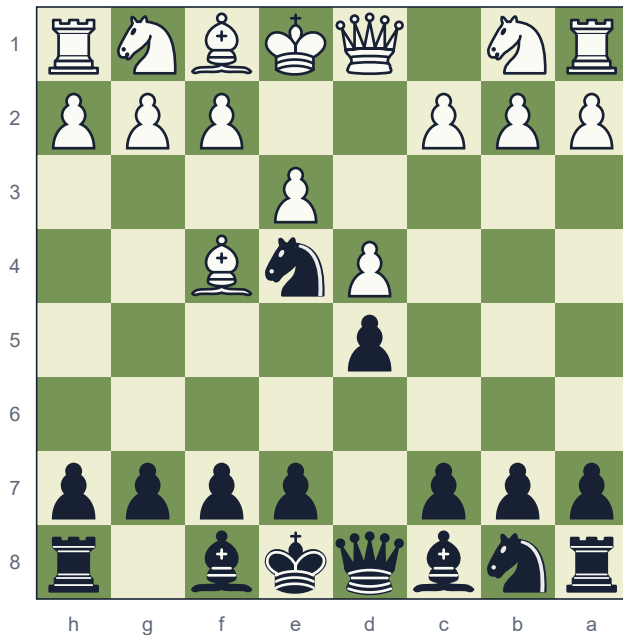
17. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

18. Black repertoire recall

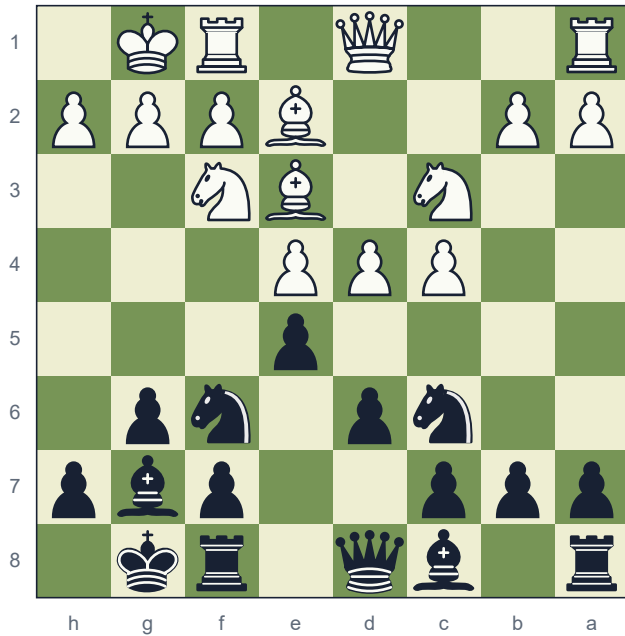
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 19-20



Black to move

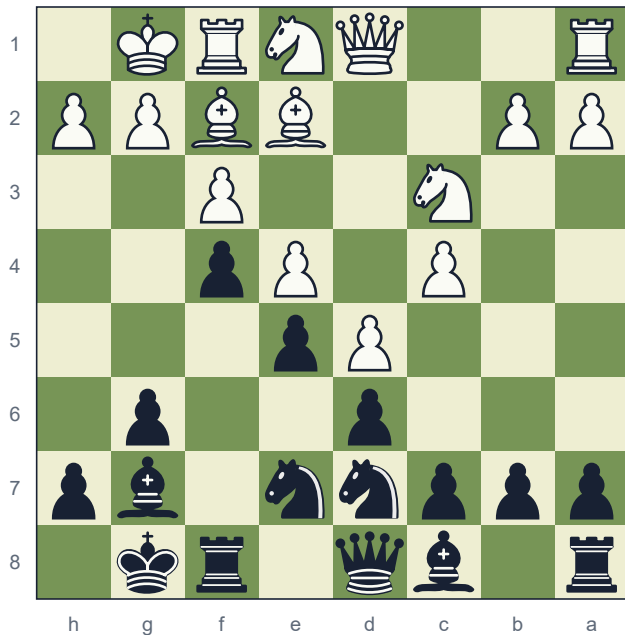
19. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

20. Black repertoire recall

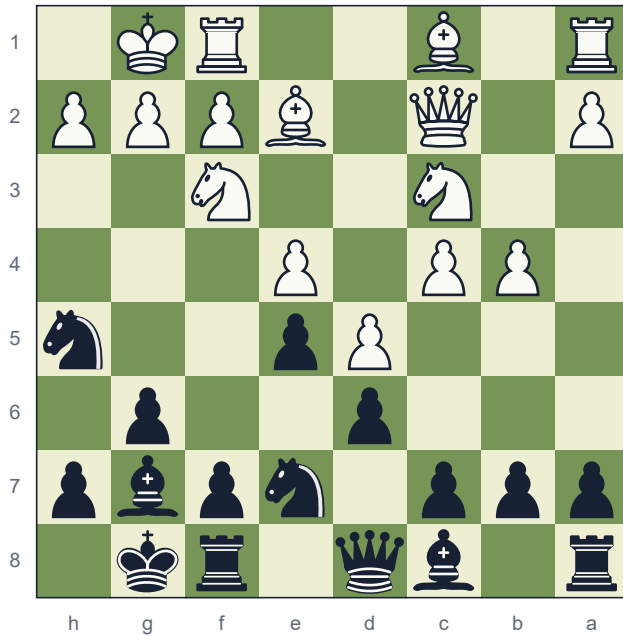
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 21-22



Black to move

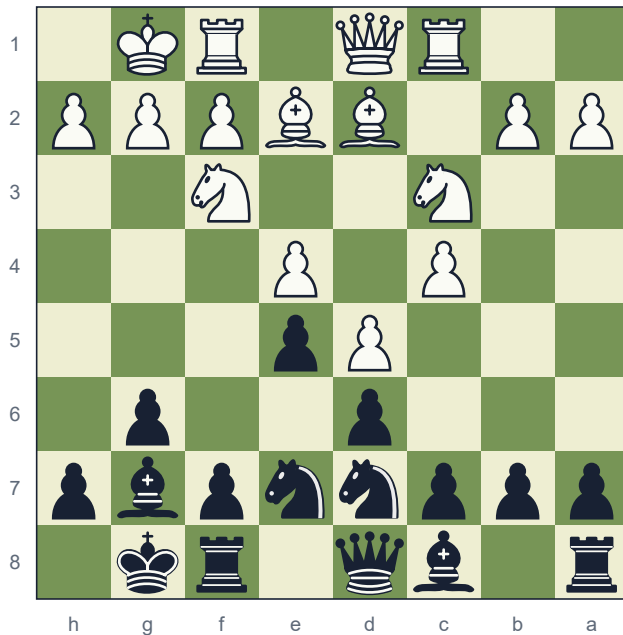
21. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

22. Black repertoire recall

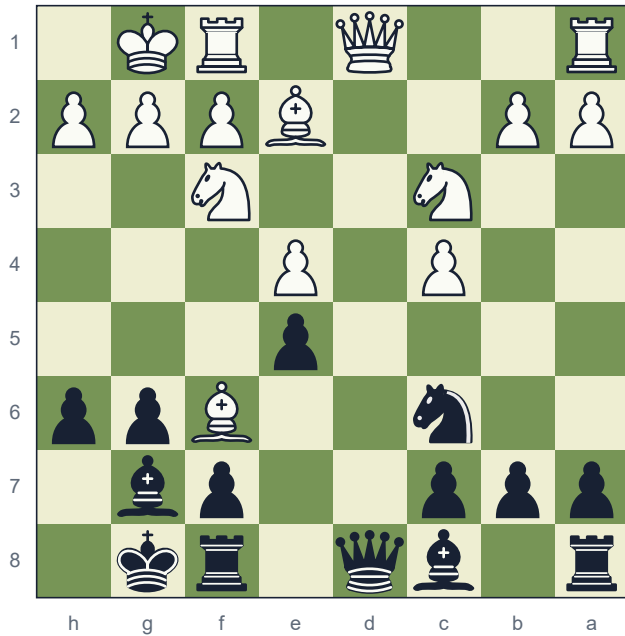
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 23-24



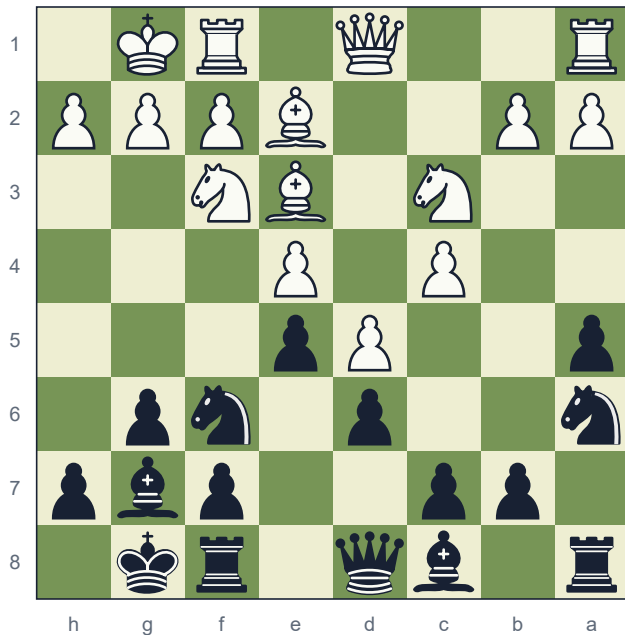
23. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



24. Black repertoire recall

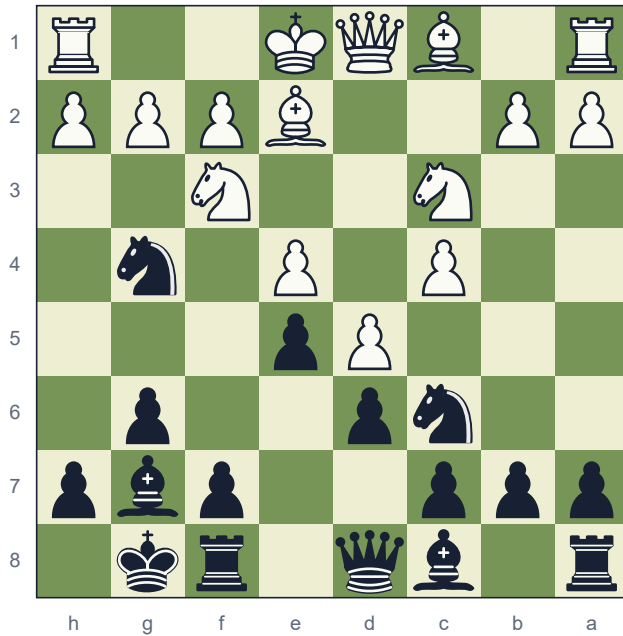
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 25-26



Black to move

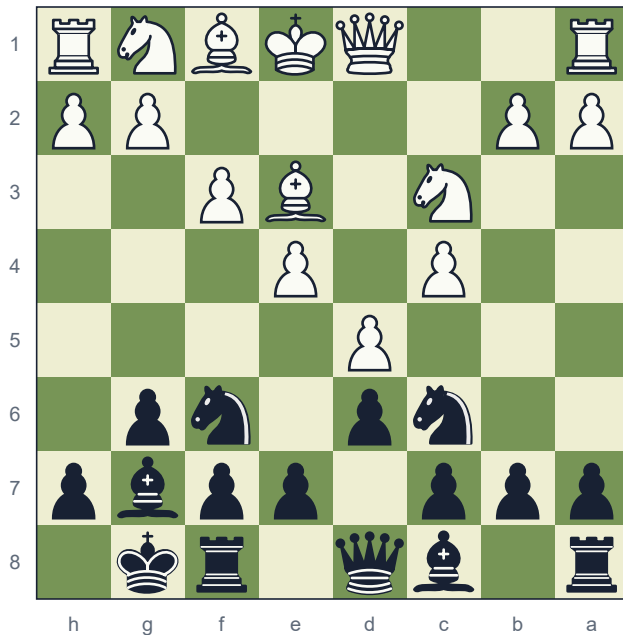
25. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

26. Black repertoire recall

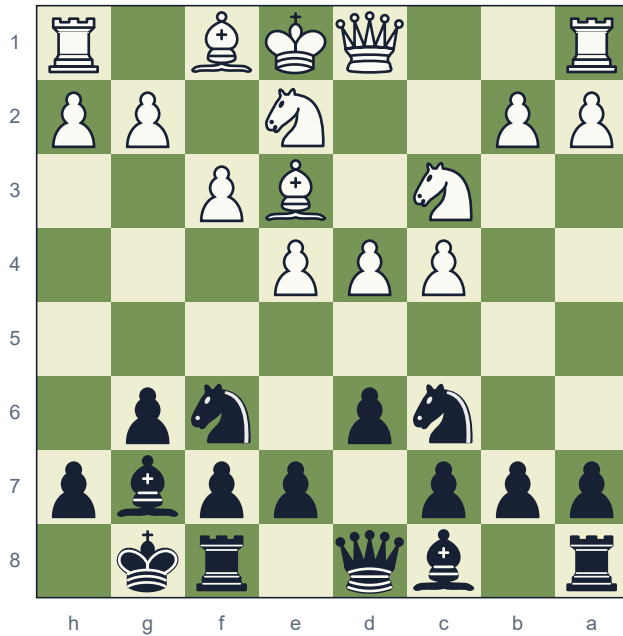
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 27-28



Black to move

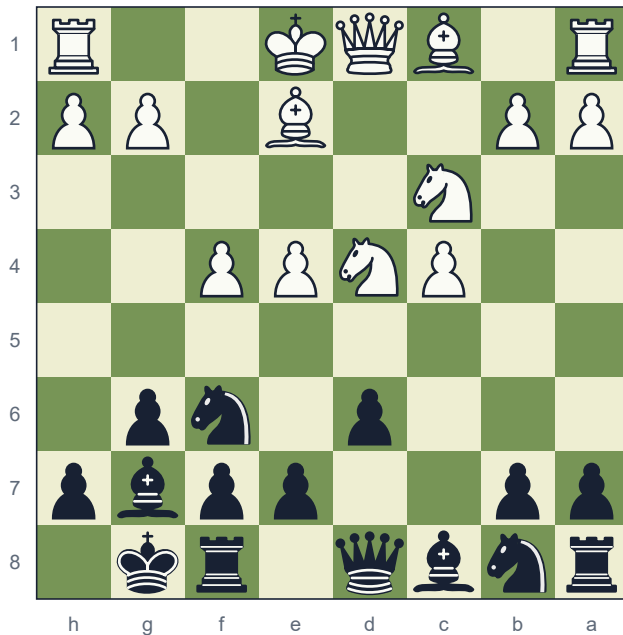
27. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

28. Black repertoire recall

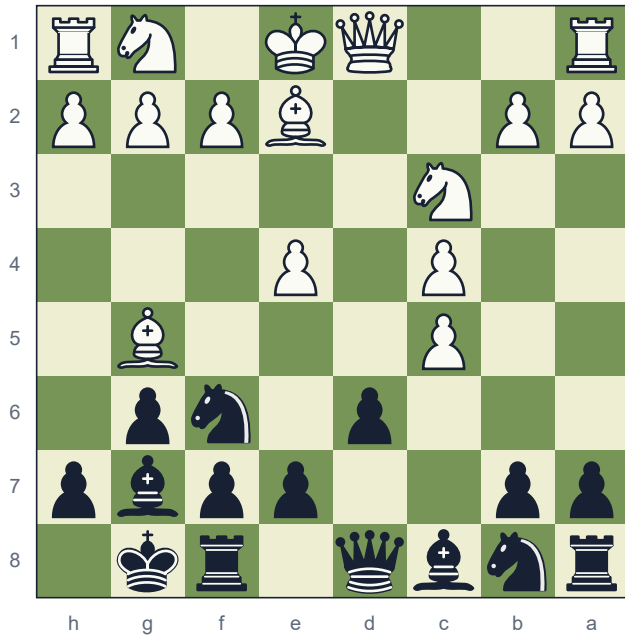
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 29-30



Black to move

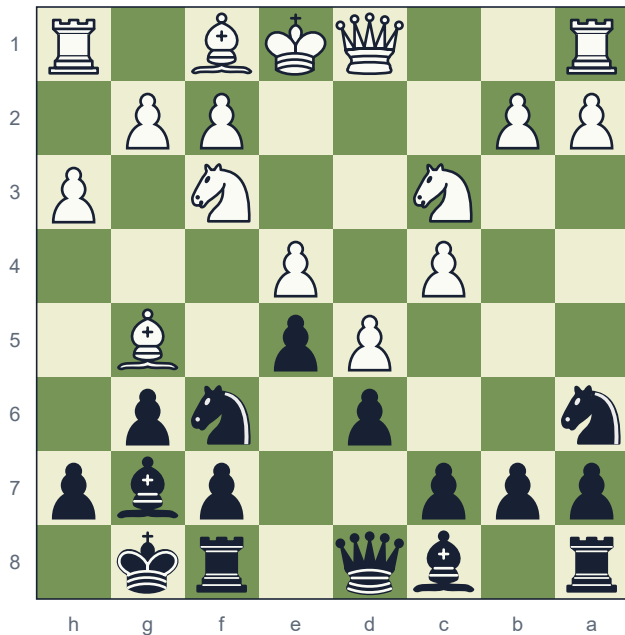
29. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

30. Black repertoire recall

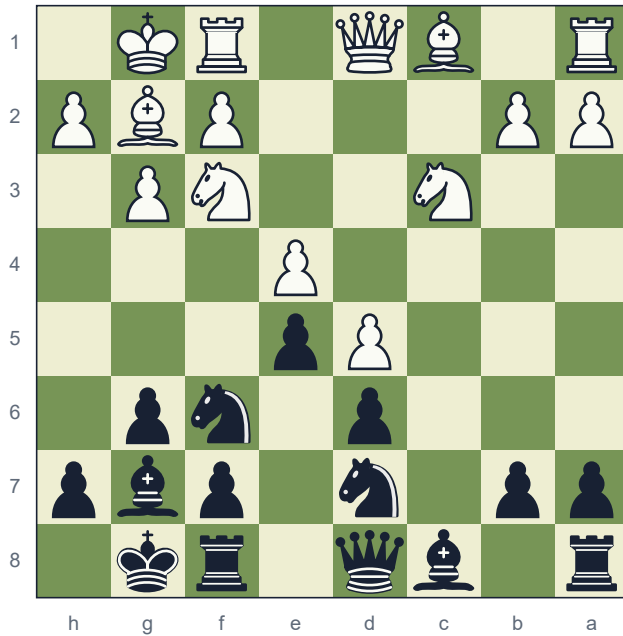
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 31-32



Black to move

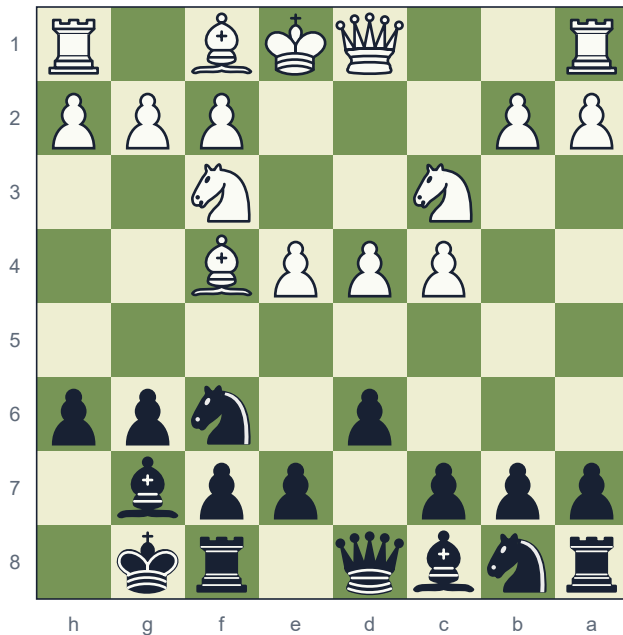
31. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

32. Black repertoire recall

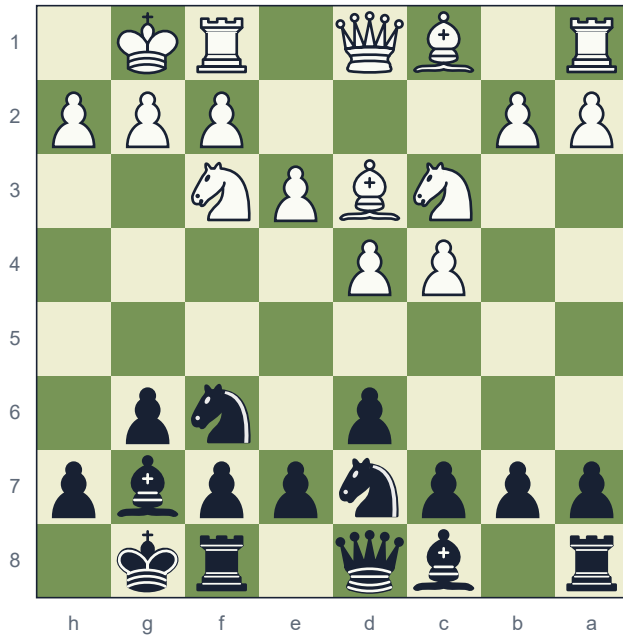
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 33-34



Black to move

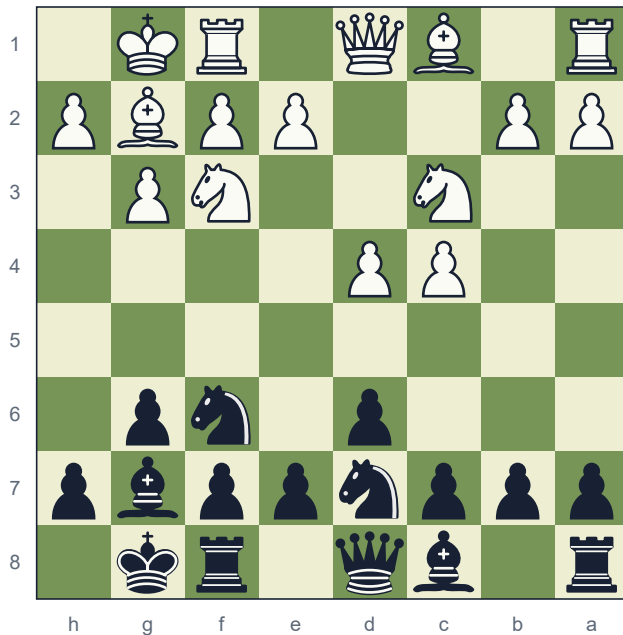
33. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

34. Black repertoire recall

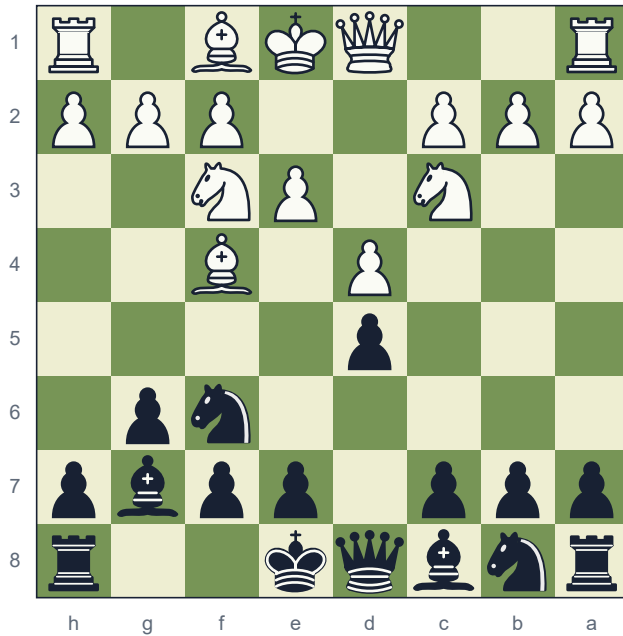
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 35-36



Black to move

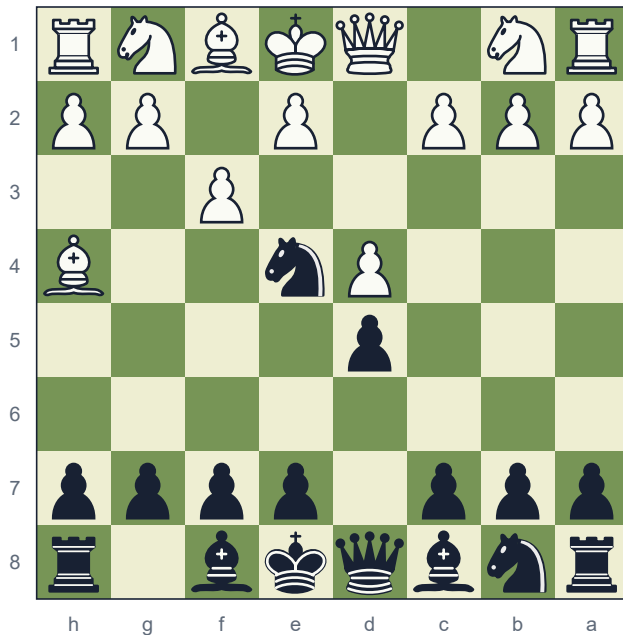
35. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

36. Black repertoire recall

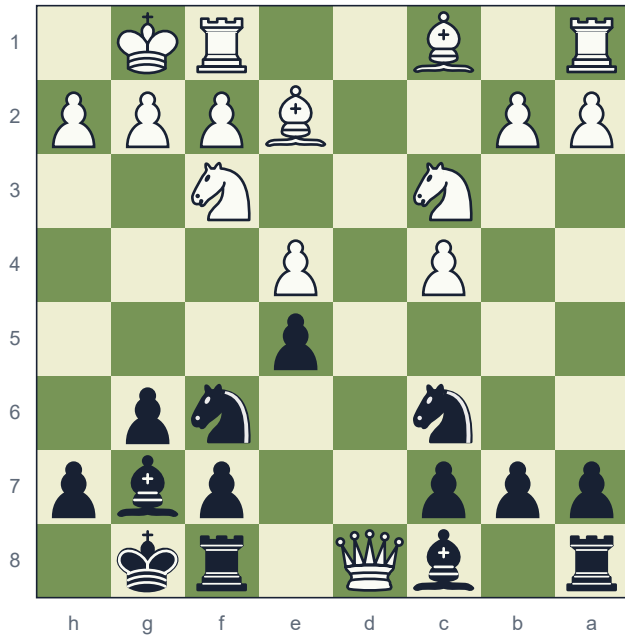
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 37-38



Black to move

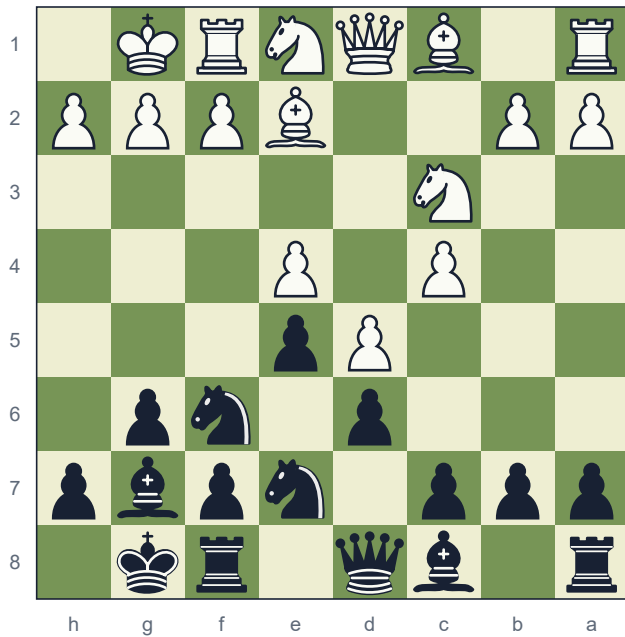
37. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

38. Black repertoire recall

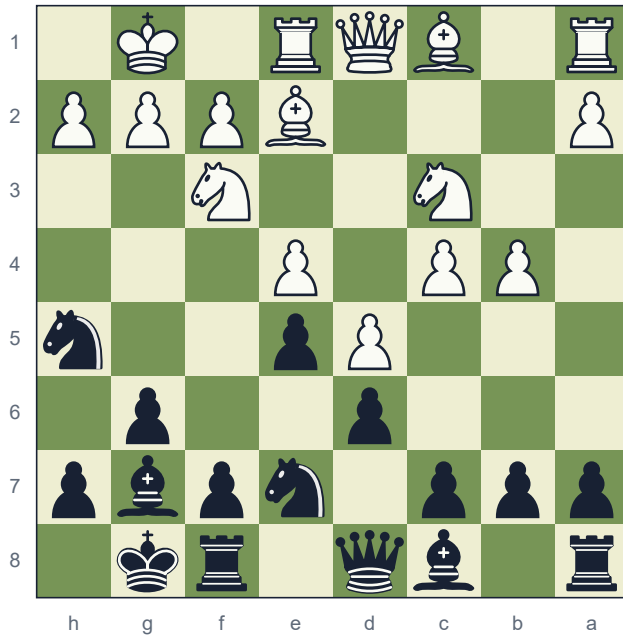
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 39-40



Black to move

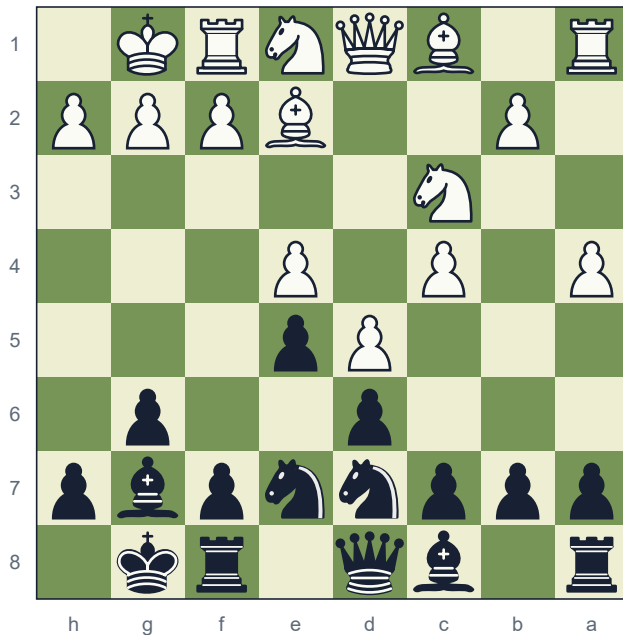
39. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

40. Black repertoire recall

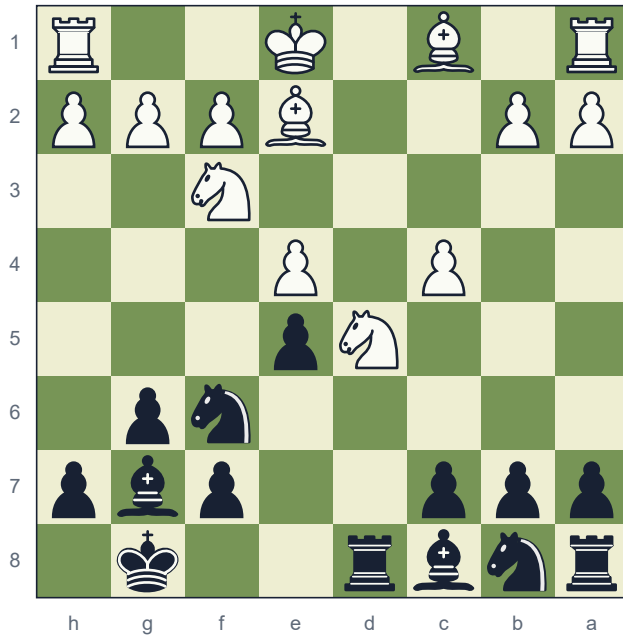
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 41-42



Black to move

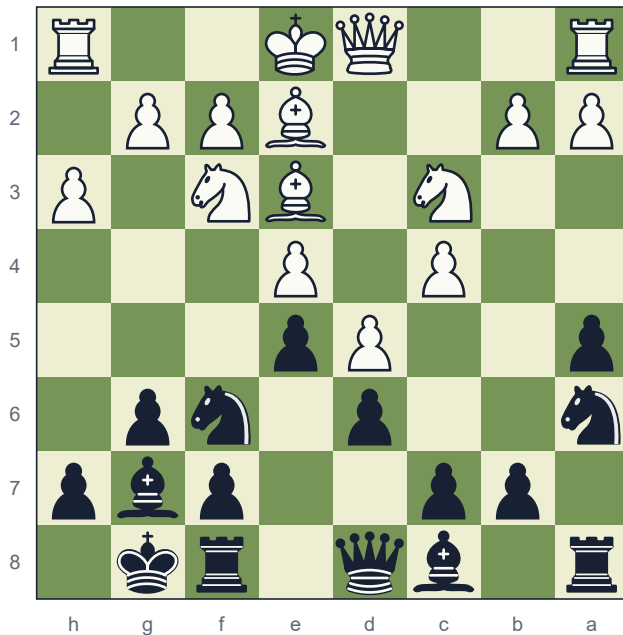
41. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

42. Black repertoire recall

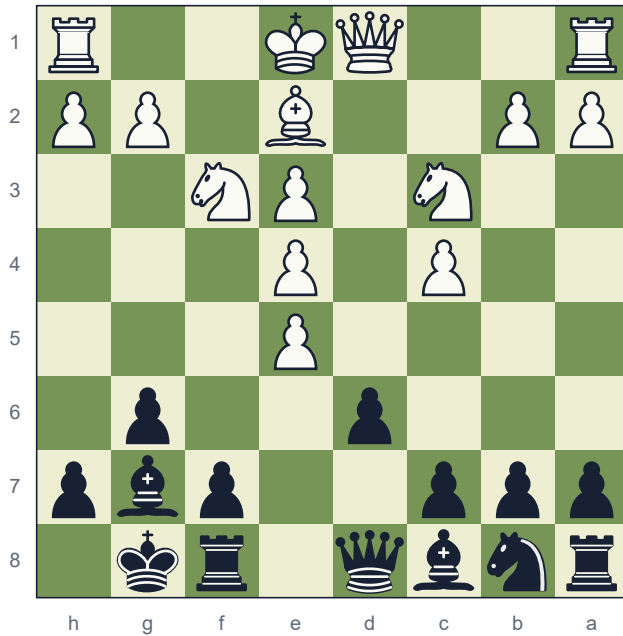
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 43-44



Black to move

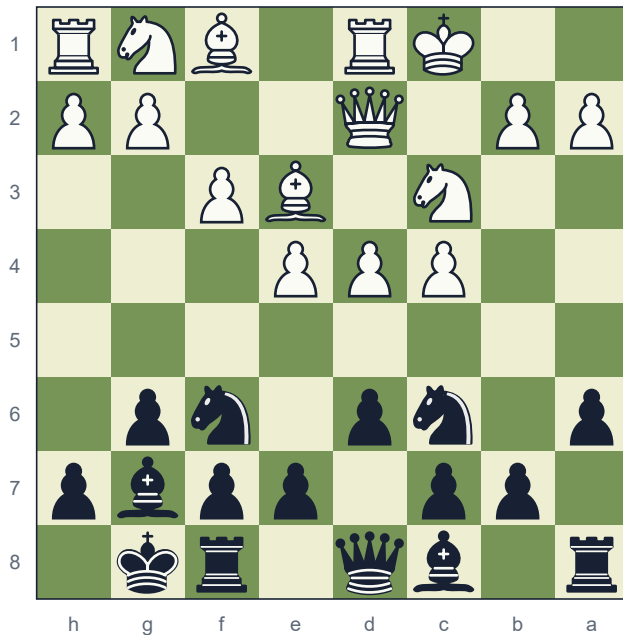
43. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

44. Black repertoire recall

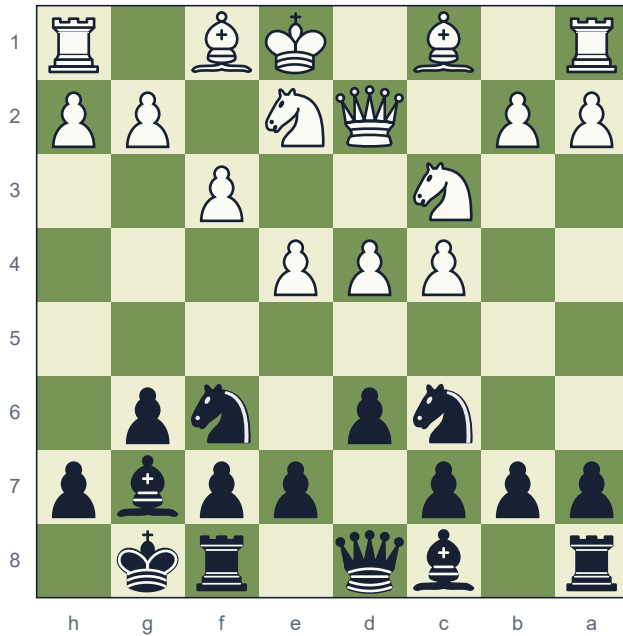
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 45-46



Black to move

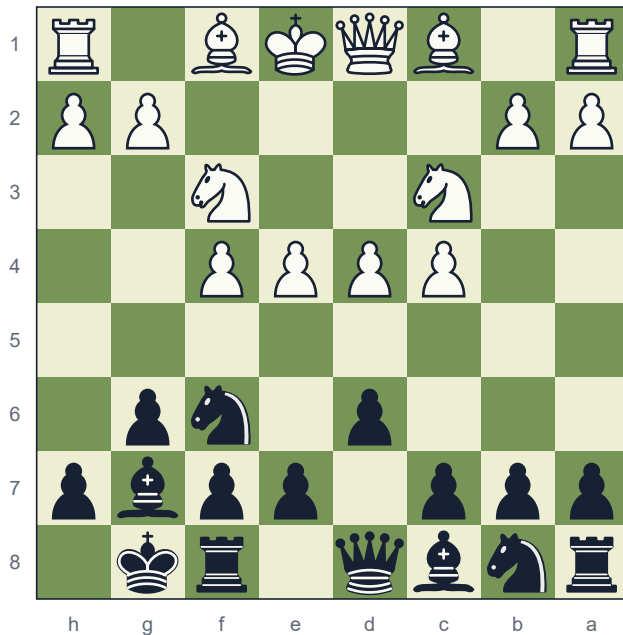
45. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

46. Black repertoire recall

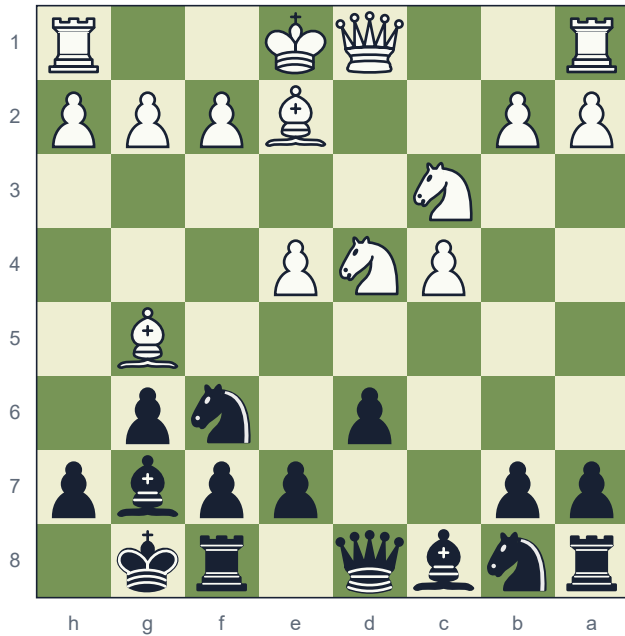
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 47-48



Black to move

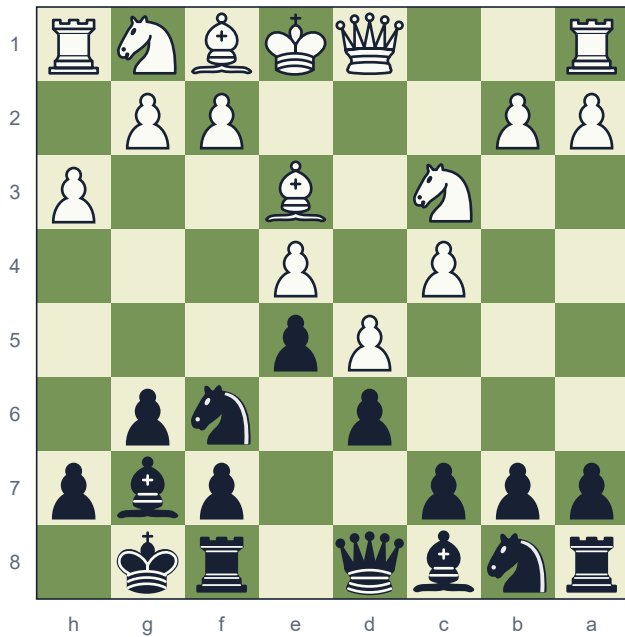
47. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

48. Black repertoire recall

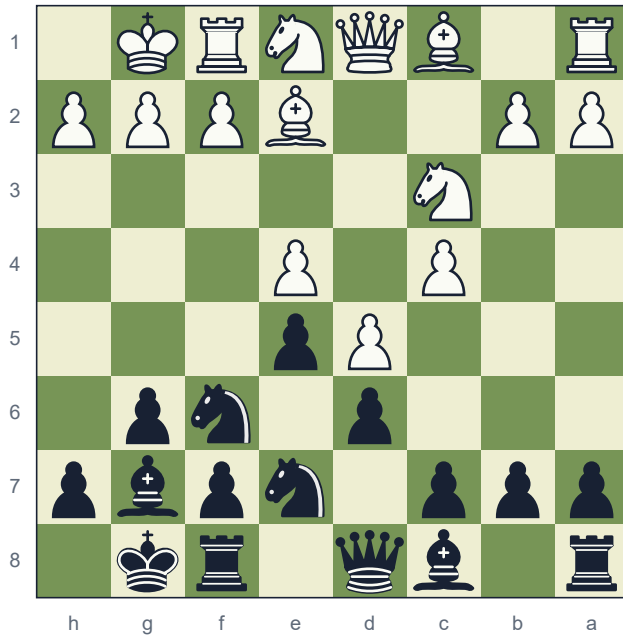
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 49-50



Black to move

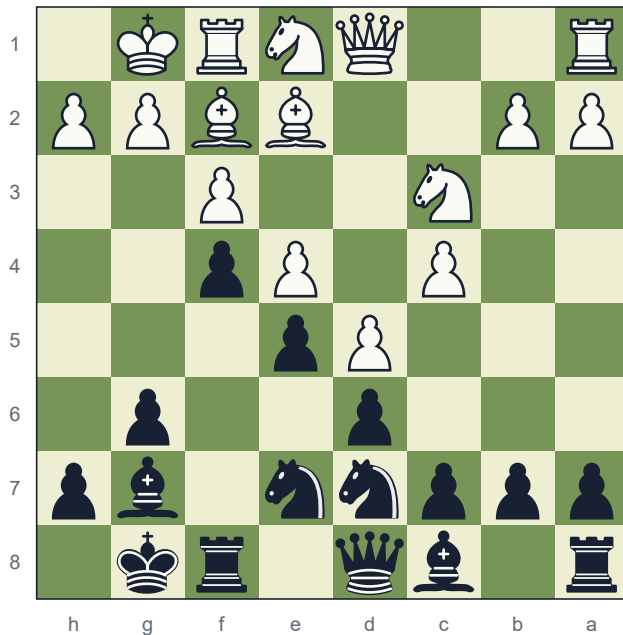
49. Plan for Black

Which knight must move before ...f5, and what is White's fastest central or queenside reply? Explain Black's plan after any necessary White reply.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

50. Plan for Black

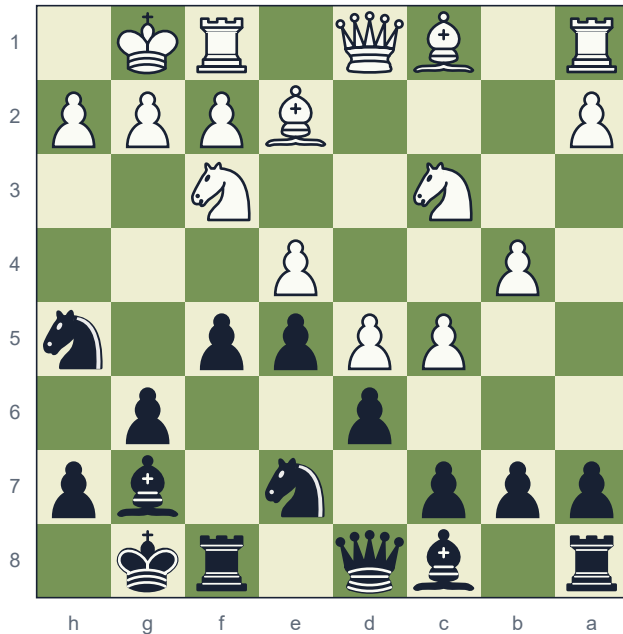
Name the first piece that should join the attack and the line it will use. Explain Black's plan after any necessary White reply.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 51-52



White to move

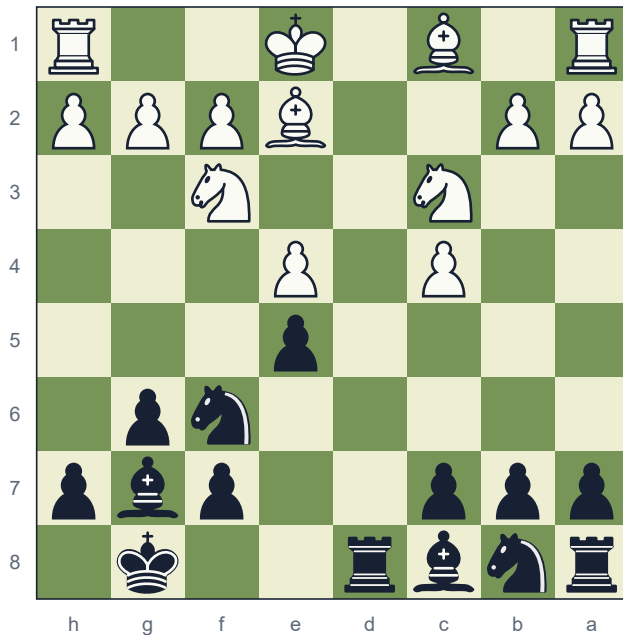
51. Plan for Black

Which captures can change the center immediately, and what file opens after each? Explain Black's plan after any necessary White reply.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



White to move

52. Plan for Black

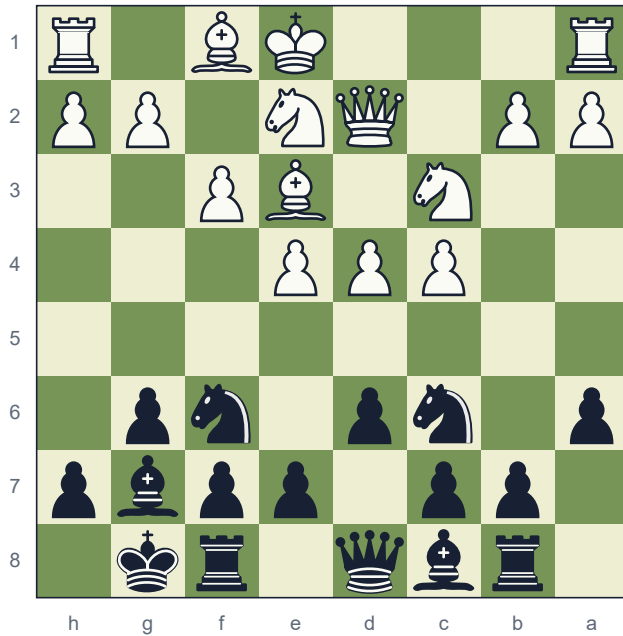
What would make a rook trade favorable, and which minor-piece square must you control? Explain Black's plan after any necessary White reply.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 53-54



White to move

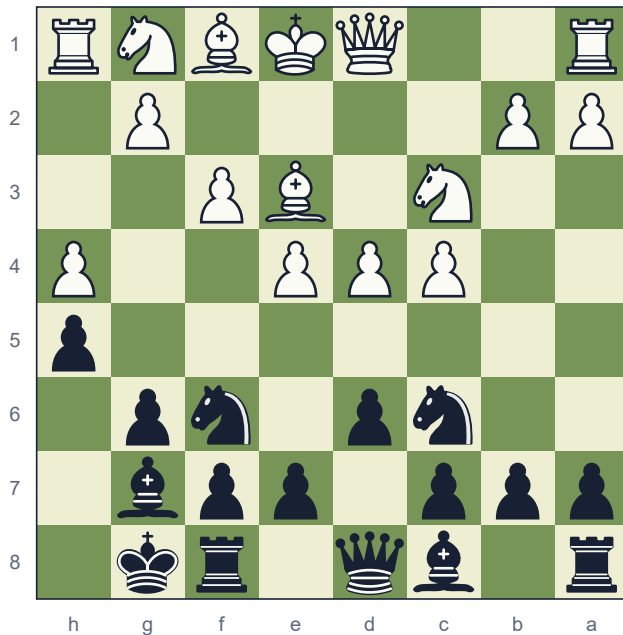
53. Plan for Black

What would change your decision between ...b5 and ...e5? Explain Black's plan after any necessary White reply.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



White to move

54. Plan for Black

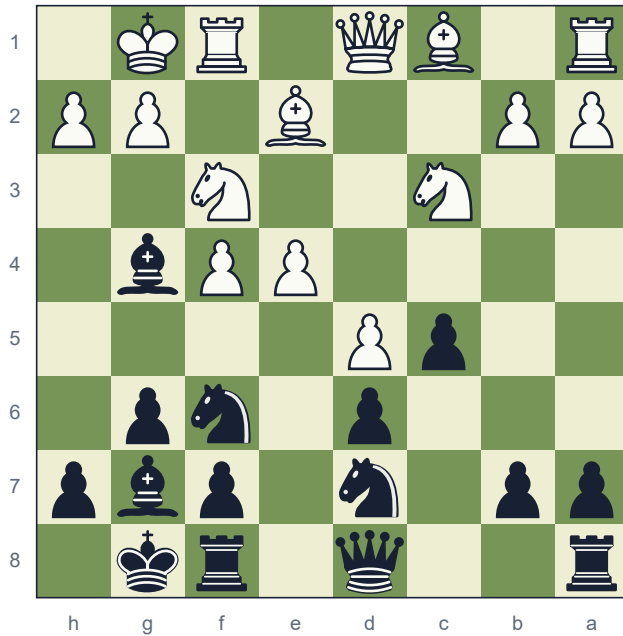
Which new pawn lever attacks h5, and what active counterplay can Black prepare? Explain Black's plan after any necessary White reply.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 55-56



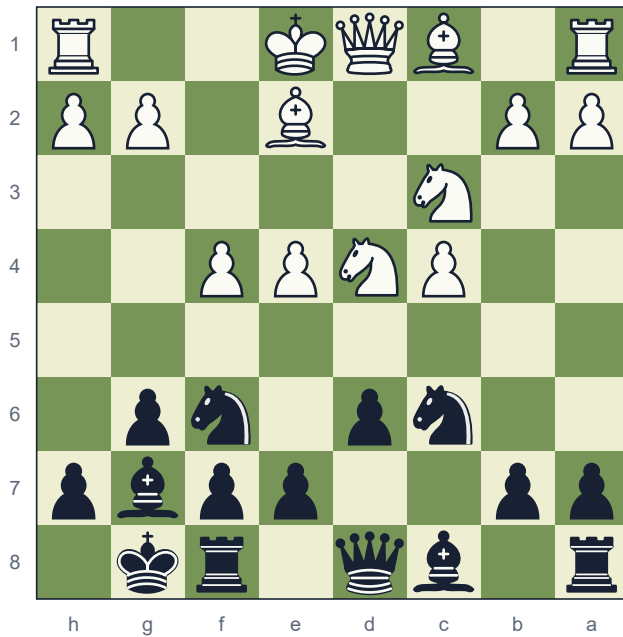
55. Plan for Black

Which white piece supports e5, and why is exchanging it potentially useful? Explain Black's plan after any necessary White reply.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



56. Plan for Black

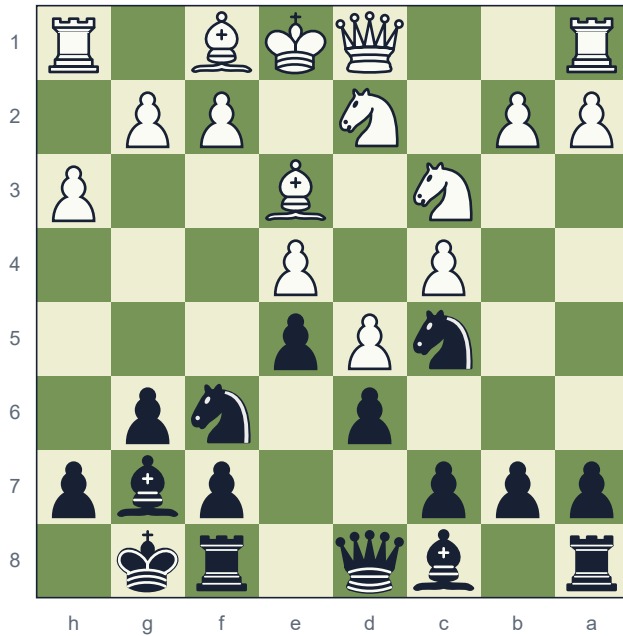
What preparation would make ...d5 a freeing break rather than a pawn sacrifice? Explain Black's plan after any necessary White reply.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 57-58



Black to move

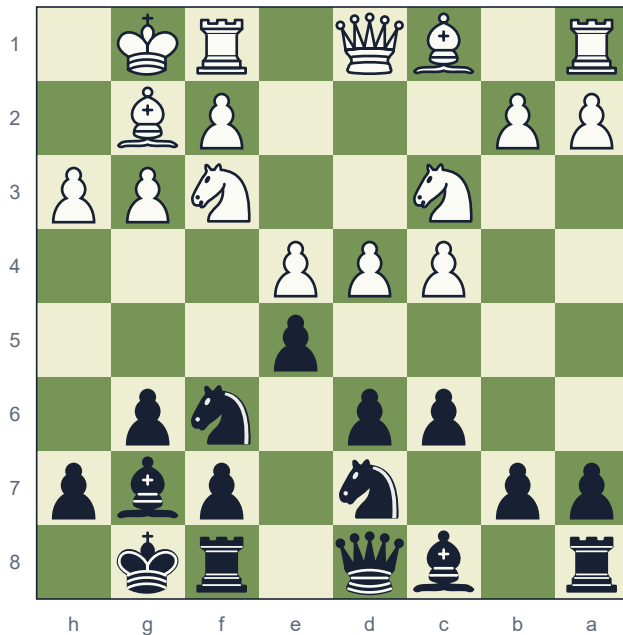
57. Plan for Black

What information about White's king do you need before launching a pawn storm? Explain Black's plan after any necessary White reply.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

58. Plan for Black

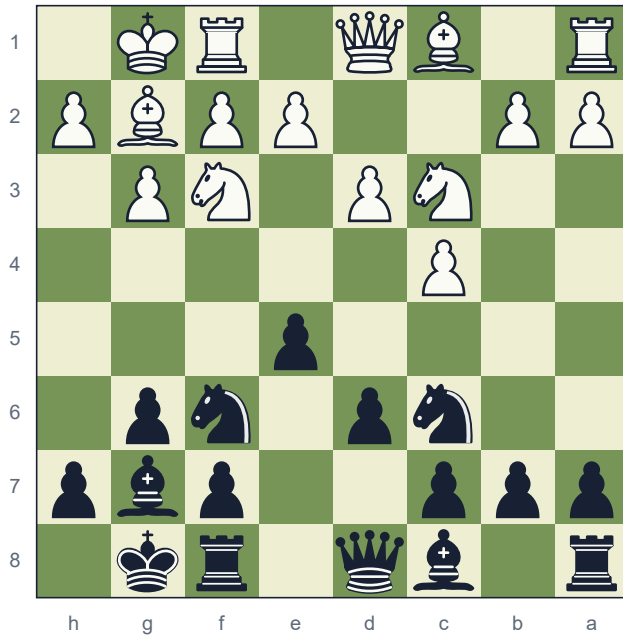
Which central exchange activates the g2 bishop, and what must Black recheck afterward? Explain Black's plan after any necessary White reply.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 59-60



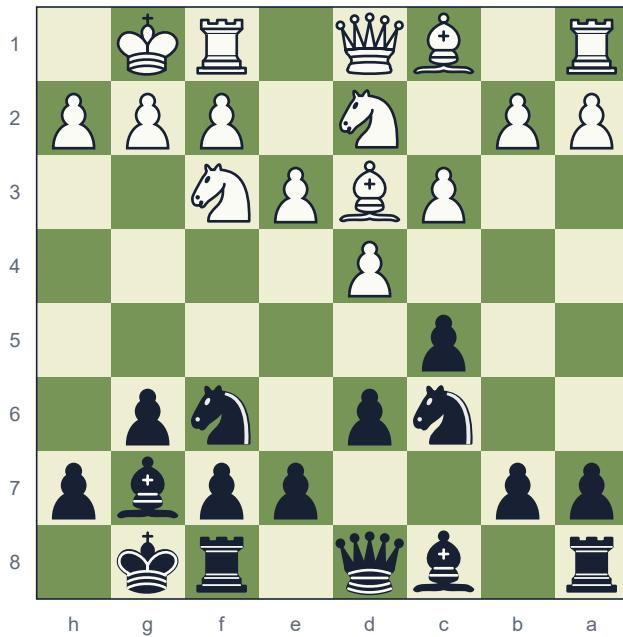
59. Plan for Black

Why is a routine Mar del Plata kingside race inappropriate in this diagram? Explain Black's plan after any necessary White reply.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



60. Plan for Black

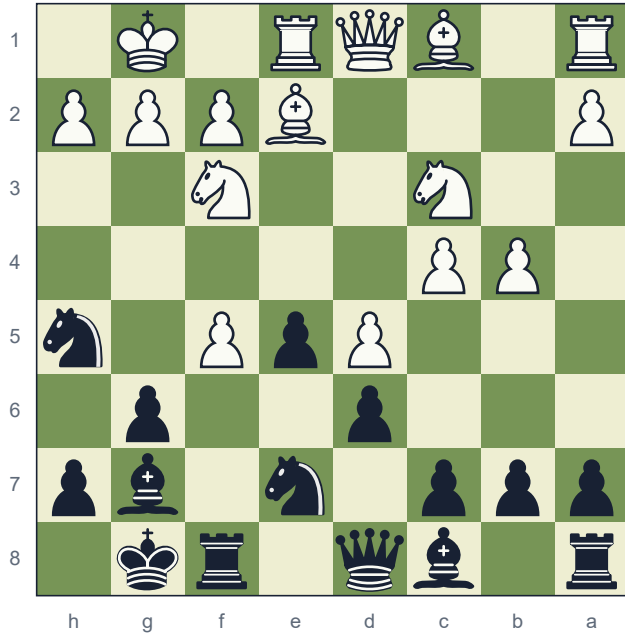
What is White's intended central break, and which black pieces should contest it? Explain Black's plan after any necessary White reply.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 61-62



Black to move

61. Concrete Black decision

White captured on f5. Find a stronger idea than an automatic recapture.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

62. Concrete Black decision

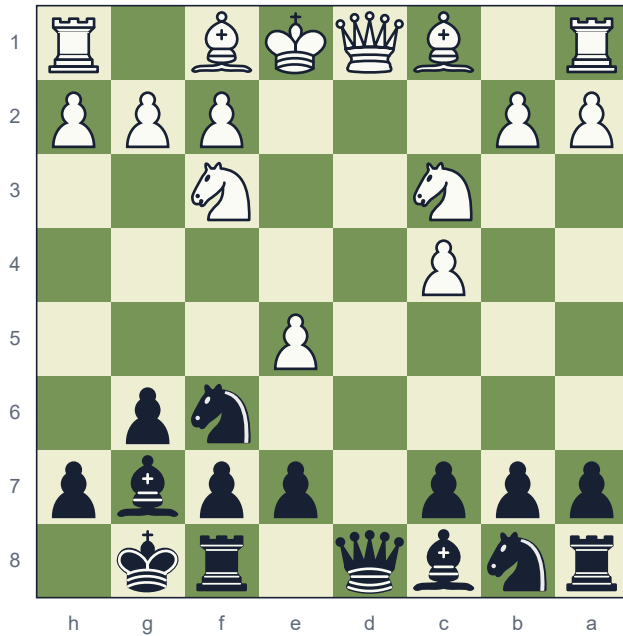
The c6 knight is attacked. Find an active square supported by the center.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 63-64



Black to move

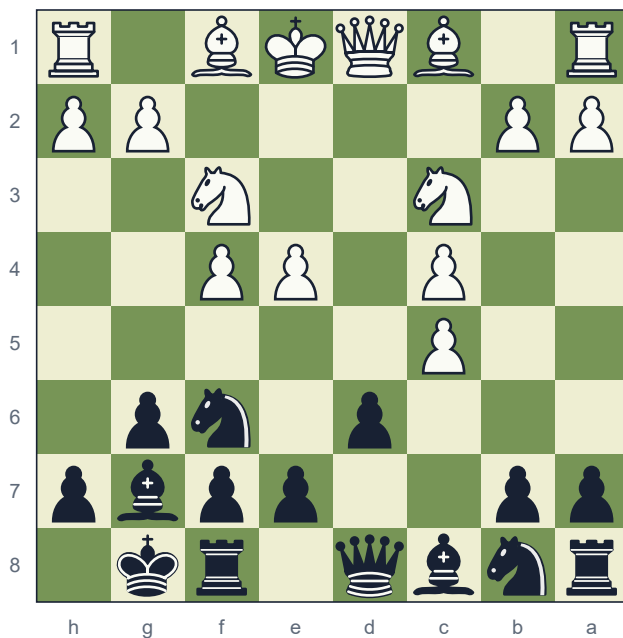
63. Concrete Black decision

White has opened the d-file. How can Black use the queen contact?

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

64. Concrete Black decision

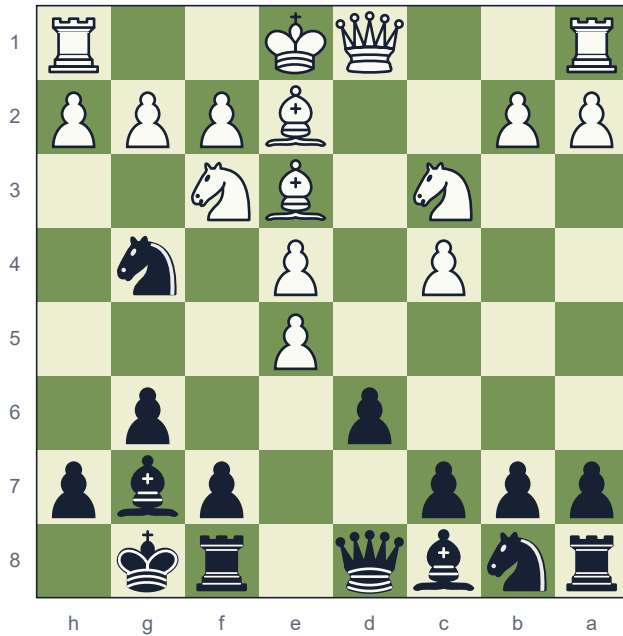
White captured on c5. Find a move that creates pressure on two central targets.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 65-66



Black to move

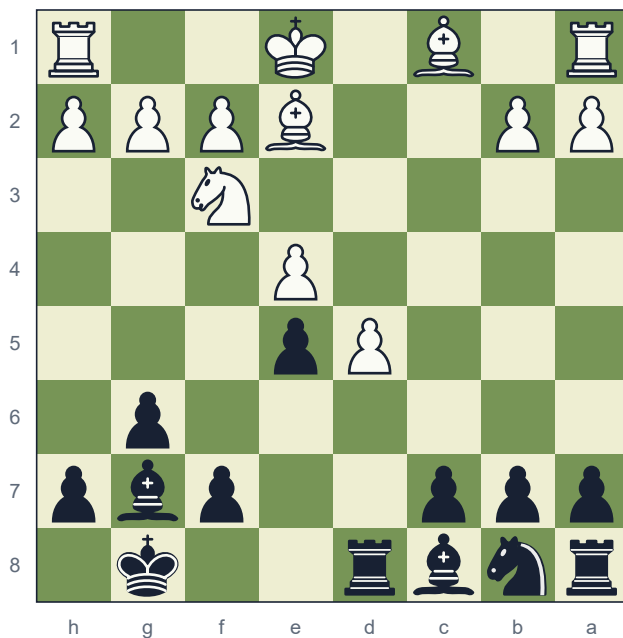
65. Concrete Black decision

White exchanged on e5 while your knight attacks a bishop. What intermediate capture is available?

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

66. Concrete Black decision

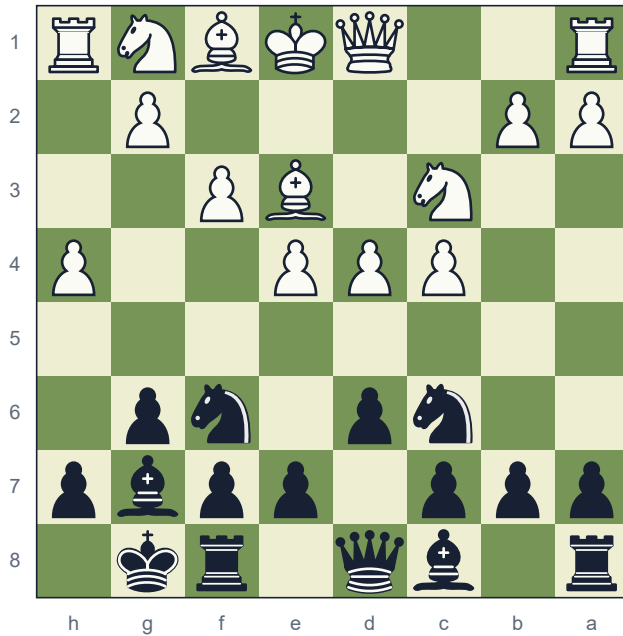
White created a pawn wedge on d5. Which pawn move challenges it?

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 67-68



Black to move

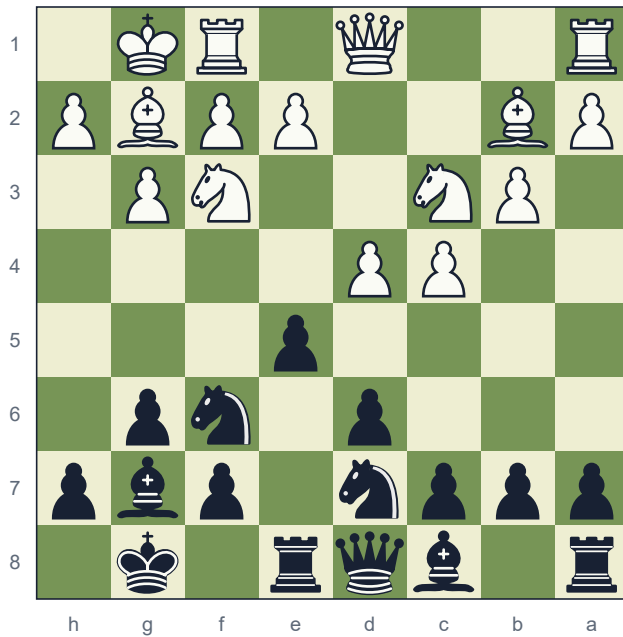
67. Concrete Black decision

White threatens h5. Give the course response and name White's next pawn lever.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

68. Concrete Black decision

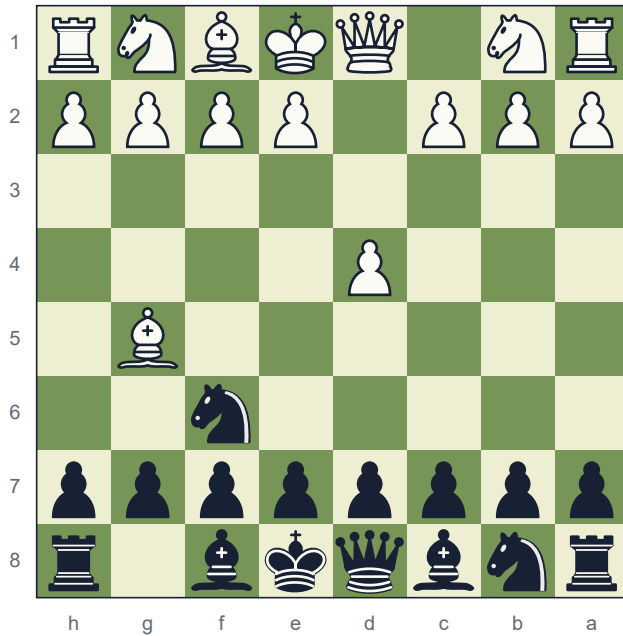
White developed the bishop on b2. Find a central advance with tempo.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 69-70



Black to move

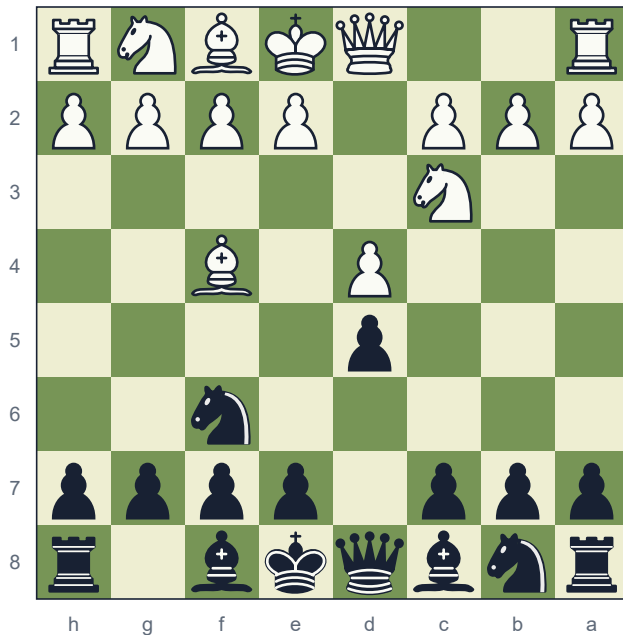
69. Concrete Black decision

White played 2.Bg5. What active knight move does the companion repertoire choose?

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

70. Concrete Black decision

White threatens a knight jump toward c7. What prophylactic move is selected?

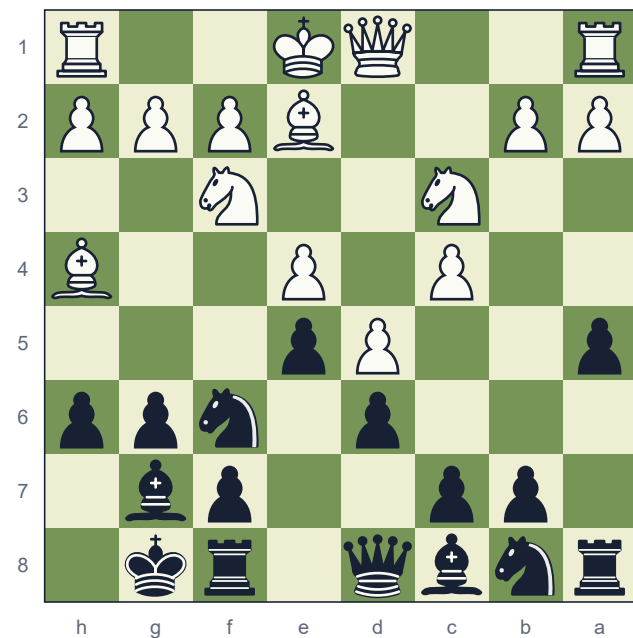
My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

1								
2								
3								
4								
5								
6								
7								
8								
	h	g	f	e	d	c	b	a

White's resource:



24 / 37

Answers 01-03

01. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 02-01

f5. Challenges e4 after the f6 square has been cleared. The center and White's king placement must justify the break. Close the center, reroute the knight, then choose the pawn break. White's broader aim: White develops behind a space advantage. Re1, Be3 and exchanges on e5 can stop Black from getting a routine kingside race.

Replay: 10... f5

02. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 03-01

Ng6. Brings a knight toward kingside entry squares while maintaining central influence. The pawn wave creates entry squares for pieces. White's broader aim: White normally expands with c5, opens c-files, and uses the e1 knight to support the queenside or defend. White can also challenge your attack with g4.

Replay: 13... Ng6

03. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 04-01

Nf6. Improves the knight on f6. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat. A retreat after ...f5 can be productive. White's broader aim: White wants c5, exchanges on d6, and an initiative before your kingside attack develops. Re1 strengthens e4 and prepares Bf1.

Replay: 11... Nf6

Answers 04-06

04. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 05-01

f5. Challenges e4 after the f6 square has been cleared. The center and White's king placement must justify the break. Restrain one break while preparing your own. White's broader aim: White may send a knight to c4, support c5, restrain ...b5 with a4, or develop the bishop on b2.

Replay: 11... f5

05. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 06-01

c6. Controls d5 and can support a later ...d5 break or challenge a white d5 wedge. King safety improves, but calculation remains necessary. White's broader aim: White may exchange queens, develop Bg5, or enter a quiet maneuvering game. White retains the first-move initiative but has given up the d5 wedge.

Replay: 10... c6

06. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 07-01

h6. Asks a bishop on g5 to choose a square and controls g5, at the cost of a potential pawn target. Flexibility comes from the knight and c-pawn. White's broader aim: White may pin Nf6, stop ...f5, and expand on the queenside while deciding where the king belongs.

Replay: 8... h6 9. Bh4 Na6 10. Nd2 Qe8

Answers 07-09

07. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 08-01

Nc6. Develops toward d4 and e5. Be ready to answer d5 if White can attack the knight. A defensive pawn move changes your attacking timetable. White's broader aim: White keeps the king flexible and may answer the knight attack by creating a pin or counterattacking in the center.

Replay: 9... Nc6 10. d5 Ne7

08. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 09-01

Rb8. Prepares queenside play on the b-file, commonly supporting ...b5. The Panno attacks the center and the queenside. White's broader aim: White may play Qd2, castle long and attack with h4, or choose a quieter king placement. White can also close with d5.

Replay: 8... Rb8 9. h4 h5 10. Nc1 Bd7

09. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 10-01

exd5. The pawn captures on d5. Follow the recapture and reassess the pawn structure before continuing the plan. Break the center before chasing the bishop. White's broader aim: White wants to pin Nf6, exchange the g7 bishop, and create a pawn lever against your king.

Replay: 8... exd5 9. Nxd5 Be6 10. h4 Bxd5

Answers 10-12

10. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 11-01

Nbd7. Develops the b8 knight and supports e5, while keeping the c-pawn flexible. Challenge the supporters of the pawn mass. White's broader aim: White wants e5 with tempo, a protected d5 wedge, and an attack supported by space. White may exchange into a central bind instead.

Replay: 10... Nbd7

11. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 12-01

exd5. The pawn captures on d5. Follow the recapture and reassess the pawn structure before continuing the plan. The identity of the recapturing pawn matters. White's broader aim: White wants to limit your kingside counterplay, support a broad center, and choose Nf3 or f4 later.

Replay: 8... exd5 9. exd5 Qb6 10. Nf3 Bf5

12. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 13-01

a5. Restrains b4 and can support a knight on c5. Respect the restraint and find another useful square. White's broader aim: White wants d5, Be3 or Bg5, and sometimes g4. The delayed king choice makes your attacking direction less automatic.

Replay: 9... a5 10. g4 a4

Answers 13-15

13. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 14-01

Re8. Places the rook on the e-file to support or pressure the center. Central counterplay is the main engine of activity. White's broader aim: White wants a safe king, strong central control, and pressure on the long diagonal. White often meets attacks by exchanging the center.

Replay: 9... Re8 10. Be3 exd4

14. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 16-01

e6. Improves the pawn on e6. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat. Early bishop development changes the tactical support. White's broader aim: White may preserve flexibility, restrain your f-pawn, or begin a king attack before normal development.

Replay: 7... e6 8. Be2 exd5 9. exd5 Qb6 10. Rc1 Re8

15. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 17-01

e5. Challenges d4 and asks White to advance, exchange or maintain the central tension. A smaller center gives Black more room to choose. White's broader aim: White develops safely with Bd3, Be2, b3 or b4 and may prepare e4 later. Quiet moves can still support a strong queenside plan.

Replay: 7... e5 8. e4 exd4 9. Nxd4 c6 10. Qc2 Re8

Answers 16-18

16. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 18-01

Nc6. Develops toward d4 and e5. Be ready to answer d5 if White can attack the knight. A real transposition is permission to reuse your study. White's broader aim: White may fianchetto, play a Botvinnik c4/d3/e4 setup, or transpose late to a standard King's Indian.

Replay: 7... Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. b4 a5 10. bxa5 Rxa5

17. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 19-01

c5. Challenges the d4 pawn from the side and creates a central contact that must be calculated. Fight the center, not the name of the system. White's broader aim: White wants a stable setup and often an e4 break. Bf4 can attack d6; Bg5 can pin Nf6.

Replay: 6... c5 7. c3 Nh5 8. Bg5 h6 9. Bh4 g5 10. Ne1 cxd4

18. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 20-01

c5. Challenges the d4 pawn from the side and creates a central contact that must be calculated. Active central play replaces the fianchetto script. White's broader aim: White may double your pawns, seize e4, or use Nb5 and Bf4 to attack c7. The aim is active development and concrete central control.

Replay: 4... c5 5. Nd2 Nxd2 6. Qxd2 cxd4 7. exd4 Bf5 8. Nf3 Nc6 9. Ne5 h5 10. Be2 e6

Answers 19-21

19. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 02-02

Re8. Places the rook on the e-file to support or pressure the center. An attacked knight may have an active forward square. White's broader aim: White develops behind a space advantage. Re1, Be3 and exchanges on e5 can stop Black from getting a routine kingside race.

Replay: 8... Re8 9. d5 Nd4 10. h3 Nxe2+

20. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 03-02

g5. Supports the advanced f-pawn and gains kingside space, while creating new king-safety responsibilities. A transposition is the same board, not a similar diagram. White's broader aim: White normally expands with c5, opens c-files, and uses the e1 knight to support the queenside or defend. White can also challenge your attack with g4.

Replay: 12... g5

21. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 04-02

f5. Challenges e4 after the f6 square has been cleared. The center and White's king placement must justify the break. Identify the actual defender of e4. White's broader aim: White wants c5, exchanges on d6, and an initiative before your kingside attack develops. Re1 strengthens e4 and prepares Bf1.

Replay: 10... f5

Answers 22-24

22. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 05-02

f5. Challenges e4 after the f6 square has been cleared. The center and White's king placement must justify the break. A pawn advance is better when it attacks something. White's broader aim: White may send a knight to c4, support c5, restrain ...b5 with a4, or develop the bishop on b2.

Replay: 10... f5

23. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 06-02

Bxf6. The bishop captures on f6. Follow the recapture and reassess the pawn structure before continuing the plan. Keep the structure and activate the pair. White's broader aim: White may exchange queens, develop Bg5, or enter a quiet maneuvering game. White retains the first-move initiative but has given up the d5 wedge.

Replay: 10... Bxf6

24. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 07-02

Ng4. Attacks a bishop on e3 or a pawn on e5 when present. The knight needs a useful follow-up or retreat. A tempo on a bishop can improve the whole setup. White's broader aim: White may pin Nf6, stop ...f5, and expand on the queenside while deciding where the king belongs.

Replay: 9... Ng4 10. Bd2 Nc5

Answers 25-27

25. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 08-02

Ne7. Keeps the knight connected to the center and can prepare a route toward g6. Use the gained tempo to improve coordination. White's broader aim: White keeps the king flexible and may answer the knight attack by creating a pin or counterattacking in the center.

Replay: 9... Ne7 10. h3 Nf6

26. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 09-02

Ne5. Improves the knight on e5. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat. Answer d5 before completing the formation. White's broader aim: White may play Qd2, castle long and attack with h4, or choose a quieter king placement. White can also close with d5.

Replay: 7... Ne5 8. f4 Neg4 9. Bd2 e6 10. dxe6 fxe6

27. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 10-02

a6. Controls b5 and can support ...b5; in the Jobava it prevents the specific Nb5 jump. A transposition must include the bishop square. White's broader aim: White wants to pin Nf6, exchange the g7 bishop, and create a pawn lever against your king.

Replay: 7... a6 8. Qd2 Rb8 9. Rc1 Bd7 10. h4 h5

Answers 28-30

28. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 11-02

Nc6. Develops toward d4 and e5. Be ready to answer d5 if White can attack the knight. When the d-pawn disappears, change the plan. White's broader aim: White wants e5 with tempo, a protected d5 wedge, and an attack supported by space. White may exchange into a central bind instead.

Replay: 8... Nc6 9. Be3 Bg4 10. Nxc6 Bxe2

29. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 12-02

Qa5. Creates concrete pressure on central or queenside targets; count tempo attacks on the queen. Use the opened diagonal, then bring the pieces out. White's broader aim: White wants to limit your kingside counterplay, support a broad center, and choose Nf3 or f4 later.

Replay: 7... Qa5 8. Bd2 Qxc5 9. Rc1 Nc6 10. Nf3 Bg4

30. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 13-02

h6. Asks a bishop on g5 to choose a square and controls g5, at the cost of a potential pawn target. A small question to the bishop is enough for now. White's broader aim: White wants d5, Be3 or Bg5, and sometimes g4. The delayed king choice makes your attacking direction less automatic.

Replay: 8... h6 9. Be3 Nc5 10. Nd2 a5

Answers 31-33

31. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 14-02

Nc5. Uses a central outpost to pressure e4 and nearby squares; check White's b4 advance. Use the c-pawn to create squares for pieces. White's broader aim: White wants a safe king, strong central control, and pressure on the long diagonal. White often meets attacks by exchanging the center.

Replay: 10... Nc5

32. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 16-02

c5. Challenges the d4 pawn from the side and creates a central contact that must be calculated. An active bishop creates a real target. White's broader aim: White may preserve flexibility, restrain your f-pawn, or begin a king attack before normal development.

Replay: 7... c5 8. d5 g5 9. Be3 e6 10. h3 exd5

33. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 17-02

e5. Challenges d4 and asks White to advance, exchange or maintain the central tension. A familiar bishop square can be a tactical target. White's broader aim: White develops safely with Bd3, Be2, b3 or b4 and may prepare e4 later. Quiet moves can still support a strong queenside plan.

Replay: 7... e5 8. h3 Re8 9. e4 exd4 10. Nxd4 Nc5

Answers 34-36

34. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 18-02

e5. Challenges d4 and asks White to advance, exchange or maintain the central tension. Fianchetto positions need their own central plan. White's broader aim: White may fianchetto, play a Botvinnik c4/d3/e4 setup, or transpose late to a standard King's Indian.

Replay: 7... e5 8. e4 exd4 9. Nxd4 Nc5 10. h3 Re8

35. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 19-02

O-O. The king moves toward shelter and the h8 rook enters the central files. A new knight square can require a new central answer. White's broader aim: White wants a stable setup and often an e4 break. Bf4 can attack d6; Bg5 can pin Nf6.

Replay: 5... O-O 6. Nb5 Na6 7. Nc3 Nb8 8. Nb5 Na6 9. Nc3 Nb8 10. Be2 c5

36. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 20-02

Nf6. Improves the knight on f6. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat. A retreat can preserve the benefits of an early sortie. White's broader aim: White may double your pawns, seize e4, or use Nb5 and Bf4 to attack c7. The aim is active development and concrete central control.

Replay: 4... Nf6 5. Nc3 c5 6. e4 Nc6 7. Bb5 Bd7 8. Bxc6 Bxc6 9. Bxf6 gxf6 10. exd5 Bxd5

Answers 37-39

37. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 02-03

Rxd8. The rook captures on d8. Follow the recapture and reassess the pawn structure before continuing the plan. An open center needs active pieces. White's broader aim: White develops behind a space advantage. Re1, Be3 and exchanges on e5 can stop Black from getting a routine kingside race.

Replay: 9... Rxd8 10. Bg5 Rf8

38. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 03-03

Nd7. Reroutes a knight toward useful central squares. Check which knight moved and whether f6 is now clear. When White breaks the chain, calculate again. White's broader aim: White normally expands with c5, opens c-files, and uses the e1 knight to support the queenside or defend. White can also challenge your attack with g4.

Replay: 9... Nd7 10. f3 f5 11. g4

39. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 04-03

f5. Challenges e4 after the f6 square has been cleared. The center and White's king placement must justify the break. Before recapturing, look for a forcing intermediate move. White's broader aim: White wants c5, exchanges on d6, and an initiative before your kingside attack develops. Re1 strengthens e4 and prepares Bf1.

Replay: 10... f5 11. exf5 e4

Answers 40-42

40. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 05-03

f5. Challenges e4 after the f6 square has been cleared. The center and White's king placement must justify the break. Space costs time; use the time purposefully. White's broader aim: White may send a knight to c4, support c5, restrain ...b5 with a4, or develop the bishop on b2.

Replay: 10... f5

41. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 06-03

Nxd5. The knight captures on d5. Follow the recapture and reassess the pawn structure before continuing the plan. Challenge a new wedge at its base. White's broader aim: White may exchange queens, develop Bg5, or enter a quiet maneuvering game. White retains the first-move initiative but has given up the d5 wedge.

Replay: 9... Nxd5 10. cxd5 c6

42. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 07-03

Nc5. Uses a central outpost to pressure e4 and nearby squares; check White's b4 advance. A good outpost still needs a retreat plan. White's broader aim: White may pin Nf6, stop ...f5, and expand on the queenside while deciding where the king belongs.

Replay: 9... Nc5 10. Nd2 Ne8

Answers 43-45

43. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 08-03

dxe5. The pawn captures on e5. Follow the recapture and reassess the pawn structure before continuing the plan. A structural concession always has a practical price. White's broader aim: White keeps the king flexible and may answer the knight attack by creating a pin or counterattacking in the center.

Replay: 9... dxe5 10. Qxd8 Rxd8

44. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 09-03

Rb8. Prepares queenside play on the b-file, commonly supporting ...b5. Attack with tempi and defend forcing threats. White's broader aim: White may play Qd2, castle long and attack with h4, or choose a quieter king placement. White can also close with d5.

Replay: 8... Rb8 9. h4 h5 10. Nd5 b5

45. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 10-03

a6. Controls b5 and can support ...b5; in the Jobava it prevents the specific Nb5 jump. Check the whole castling path. White's broader aim: White wants to pin Nf6, exchange the g7 bishop, and create a pawn lever against your king.

Replay: 7... a6 8. Qd1 Rb8 9. Rb1 b5 10. cxb5 axb5

Answers 46-48

46. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 11-03

c5. Challenges the d4 pawn from the side and creates a central contact that must be calculated. Central captures can expose two targets at once. White's broader aim: White wants e5 with tempo, a protected d5 wedge, and an attack supported by space. White may exchange into a central bind instead.

Replay: 6... c5 7. dxc5 Qa5 8. Bd2 Qxc5 9. Rc1 Na6 10. a3 Qc6

47. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 12-03

Nc6. Develops toward d4 and e5. Be ready to answer d5 if White can attack the knight. Open central squares reward active pieces. White's broader aim: White wants to limit your kingside counterplay, support a broad center, and choose Nf3 or f4 later.

Replay: 8... Nc6 9. Be3 Bd7 10. Qd2 Qa5

48. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 13-03

Na6. Develops the b8 knight toward c5 without blocking the c-pawn. Delayed development can preserve dangerous options. White's broader aim: White wants d5, Be3 or Bg5, and sometimes g4. The delayed king choice makes your attacking direction less automatic.

Replay: 7... Na6 8. g4 Nc5 9. f3 a5 10. Qd2 c6

Answers 49-51

49. PLAN FOR BLACK | SEE 21 / THE LOCKED CLASSICAL CHAIN

White's d5/e4 chain faces Black's d6/e5 chain. Neither d-pawn can move straight forward. The chain gives a direction to the plans, but either side can open it with a pawn lever. Prepare ...f5 by moving the f6 knight and coordinating the pieces. If ...f4 fixes the center, use the gained space to bring pieces toward the king. White: White expands with c5 and may invade on the c-file. White can also undermine the attack with g4. Count how many moves your pieces need.

50. PLAN FOR BLACK | SEE 21 / AFTER ...F4: SPACE IS NOT A MATING ATTACK

The f4 pawn gains space and restricts White's pieces. It also fixes targets and closes lines your own rooks might otherwise use. Support the pawn with ...g5 only if the pieces can join. Typical jobs include ...Ng6, ...Nf6, ...h5 and queen access. Identify the entry square, not just the next pawn. White: White may play c5, g4, or bring defenders to f2 and d3. If the attack slows, the queenside weaknesses can become decisive.

51. PLAN FOR BLACK | SEE 21 / THE BAYONET: TWO SIMULTANEOUS PAWN CONTACTS

White's c5 attacks d6 while Black's f5 attacks e4. The locked center can open from either end, so a one-wing evaluation is incomplete. Compare ...f4, ...fxe4 and a d-pawn exchange only after analyzing White's captures. Preserve piece activity if the pawn skeleton changes. White: White can trade on d6 or f5 and use open files before Black finishes regrouping.

Answers 52-54

52. PLAN FOR BLACK | SEE 21 / THE OPEN D-FILE AFTER AN EXCHANGE

Both d-pawns have left the d-file, and the queens are gone. A direct mating race has been replaced by piece coordination and control of d4 and d5. Develop the remaining pieces and contest the d-file. Keep e5 defended, especially if a bishop pins Nf6. A rook on an open file needs support and entry squares. White: White may invade d5 with a knight or double rooks. A passive black bishop can be worse than a small pawn weakness.

53. PLAN FOR BLACK | SEE 21 / PANNO: THE QUEENSIDE BREAK

Black has ...Nc6, ...a6 and ...Rb8. White's f3 pawn supports the center but delays natural king-knight development. Prepare ...b5 when the captures work. If White restrains it with a4, compare ...e5. If White closes with d5, answer the knight attack first. White: Bh6, h4 and g4 can threaten the king. White may avoid long castling and turn the queenside opening into a central game.

54. PLAN FOR BLACK | SEE 21 / SAMISCH: DEFENDING THE KING WITHOUT PASSIVITY

The h-pawns face one another after ...h5. The h-file is closed for now, but White can create a new lever with g4. Finish development and create central or queenside counterplay. Defend forcing threats directly. Keep a defender near g6 and avoid unnecessary dark-square weaknesses. White: White may play g4, sacrifice on h5, or exchange the g7 bishop with Bh6. A blocked h-file is not permanent safety.

Answers 55-57

55. PLAN FOR BLACK | SEE 21 / BENONI STRUCTURE AGAINST THE FOUR PAWNS

White has a d5 wedge and an e4/f4 center; Black has d6 and c5. Black's e-pawn has been exchanged, opening the e-file. Pressure e4, challenge the knight that supports e5, and develop rapidly. Prepare queenside expansion only when d6 and the king are secure. White: White threatens e5 with tempo or a kingside attack. A passive setup lets the space advantage grow.

56. PLAN FOR BLACK | SEE 21 / THE CENTRAL BIND AFTER ...CXD4

White's d-pawn has disappeared. Pawns on c4 and e4 control d5, restricting Black's central break. Develop toward a supported ...d5 or create useful queenside pressure. Trade a pair of pieces when it reduces the cramp without conceding a permanent weakness. White: White can maintain the bind, improve pieces and attack d6. An unsupported ...d5 may simply lose a pawn.

57. PLAN FOR BLACK | SEE 21 / MAKOGONOV: RESTRAINT BEFORE ATTACK

h3 restrains g4 and supports a possible g4 advance. The c5 knight gives Black activity but can be challenged by b4. Coordinate pieces behind the center. Compare ...a5, ...c6 and a prepared ...f5; choose according to White's king and the knight's safety. White: White can attack on the kingside while delaying castling, or gain queenside space against Nc5.

Answers 58-60

58. PLAN FOR BLACK | SEE 21 / FIANCHETTO: PRESSURE THROUGH THE CENTER

Both kings have fianchettoed bishops. White's g2 bishop adds a defender and a long-range attacker, changing the value of a kingside pawn advance. Develop central pressure with ...Re8, ...exd4 and a knight on c5 when justified. ...c6 can support a later ...d5 break. White: White may open the long diagonal with a central exchange. An exposed b7 pawn or loose c6 piece can then become a target.

59. PLAN FOR BLACK | SEE 21 / ENGLISH: NO D4 WEDGE

White uses d3 rather than d4. Black's e5 foothold controls d4, and there is no locked d5/e4 chain. Develop the queen bishop and consider a well-supported ...d5. Watch queenside expansion and use central squares for pieces. White: White can play Rb1/b4, f4, or d4 later. Each advance changes which pawn break is most relevant.

60. PLAN FOR BLACK | SEE 21 / SYSTEM OPENINGS: STOP A FREE E4 BREAK

White has a compact d4/e3 center and Bd3. Black attacks d4 with ...c5 and develops against the coming e4 advance. Increase central pressure with ...Nc6 and useful bishop development. Resolve the pawn tension only when the resulting structure helps you. White: White can prepare e4 with Nbd2 and Re1. If the center opens, Bd3 may create threats toward h7.

Answers 61-63

61. CONCRETE BLACK DECISION | SEE 04-03

e4. The intermediate ...e4 attacks Nf3 and opens the g7 bishop toward Nc3. Calculate the combined threats before recovering a pawn.

Replay: 11... e4

62. CONCRETE BLACK DECISION | SEE 02-02

Nd4. ...Nd4 uses support from e5 and the e-file pressure from Re8. Calculate both minor-piece captures and the recapture.

Replay: 9... Nd4 10. h3 Nxe2+

63. CONCRETE BLACK DECISION | SEE 02-05

Qxd1+. ...Qxd1 forces a queen exchange and changes the task to attacking e5 and developing the pieces.

Replay: 7... Qxd1+ 8. Nxd1 Ng4 9. Bf4 Nc6 10. Ne3 Nb4

Answers 64-66

64. CONCRETE BLACK DECISION | SEE 11-03

Qa5. ...Qa5 pressures c5 and e4. Continue the calculation through attacks on the queen before claiming material.

Replay: 7... Qa5 8. Bd2 Qxc5 9. Rc1 Na6 10. a3 Qc6

65. CONCRETE BLACK DECISION | SEE 08-03

Nxe3. ...Nxe3 exchanges the knight for the bishop before the d-pawn recaptures on e5. White's f-pawn recapture changes the structure.

Replay: 8... Nxe3 9. fxe3 dxe5 10. Qxd8 Rxd8

66. CONCRETE BLACK DECISION | SEE 06-03

c6. ...c6 questions the new wedge. Compare dxc6 and ...cxd5 by rook activity and the resulting pawn targets.

Replay: 10... c6

Answers 67-69

67. CONCRETE BLACK DECISION | SEE 10-04

h5. ...h5 blocks the immediate lever. White can now use g4 against h5, so Black still needs central or queenside activity.

Replay: 7... h5 8. Qd2 a6 9. O-O-O Rb8 10. Nd5 b5

68. CONCRETE BLACK DECISION | SEE 14-05

e4. ...e4 attacks Nf3 and gains space. Support the advanced pawn and calculate the knight retreat before treating it as a permanent advantage.

Replay: 9... e4 10. Ng5 e3

69. CONCRETE BLACK DECISION | SEE 20-01

Ne4. ...Ne4 attacks the bishop and prepares a central game with ...d5 and ...c5. The knight can retreat later if White plays f3.

Replay: 2... Ne4 3. Bf4 d5 4. e3 c5 5. Nd2 Nxd2 6. Qxd2 cxd4 7. exd4 Bf5 8. Nf3 Nc6 9. Ne5 h5 10. Be2 e6

Answers 70-72

70. CONCRETE BLACK DECISION | SEE 20-04

a6. ...a6 prevents Nb5. Black then returns to central development and ...c5.

Replay: 3... a6 4. e3 e6 5. Nf3 c5 6. dxc5 Bxc5 7. Bd3 Nc6 8. O-O Bb4 9. a3 Bxc3 10. bxc3 O-O

71. CONCRETE BLACK DECISION | SEE 12-04

Re8. ...Re8 increases central pressure and supports the struggle against e4. This is an Averbakh/Benoni structure, not a closed ...e5 chain.

Replay: 9... Re8 10. Nd2 h6

72. CONCRETE BLACK DECISION | SEE 07-01

Na6. ...Na6 offers c5 and preserves the c-pawn's flexibility. Black has already used ...a5 to restrain b4.

Replay: 9... Na6 10. Nd2 Qe8